

Evan Mobley (Order #29860615)

CHAPTER 2

CHARACTERS

Characters include all beings in the game world, from the Heroes run by the players to the Villains, Foes, Minions, and Extras run by the GM. They include not only sentient beings but also animals, monsters, mindless undead, unthinking robots, career politicians, and so on. This chapter discusses the kinds of characters in the game and the characteristics used to describe them. It also provides rules for creating Heroes and having them develop and become more capable over time.

CHARACTER TYPES

There are five types of characters: Heroes, Villains, Foes, Minions, and Extras. **Heroes** are the characters run by the players. The GM runs all other characters, so they're sometimes called non-player characters or **NPCs**. **Villains** are the super-powered adversaries whose diabolical schemes the Heroes spend their time trying to thwart. **Foes** are lesser enemies, characters important or powerful enough to merit individualized attention, but not enough to make them true Villains. They typically serve archvillains as henchmen and henchwomen, but usually report to the archvillain's lieutenants, who are often Villains in their own right. **Minions** are the nameless foot soldiers who attack Heroes in groups and get knocked around like tenpins when the Heroes run out of bubblegum. Last are **Extras**, characters who could be allies, enemies, or something else entirely.

HEROES

Heroes are defined by the following characteristics: Abilities, Talents, Powers, Perks, and Flaws. These characteristics are more than just descriptive. Each plays a mechanical role in the game and is discussed in greater detail later in this chapter. Heroes also possess narrative elements that help turn a collection of stats into a three-dimensional character. Most of this chapter discusses the process of creating Heroes (and other characters) and the options available when doing so.

VILLAINS

Most Villains are defined by the same characteristics as Heroes: Abilities, Talents, Powers, Perks, and Flaws. Some Villains aren't important or intelligent enough to have Talents, but otherwise Villains and Heroes have identical characteristics. As discussed later in this chapter, Villains are created much like Heroes, but the process is easier because it doesn't involve any bookkeeping. Like Heroes, Villains have their own narrative elements that describe who they are, what they want, and so on. However, these elements differ from those used for Heroes. This is covered in Chapter 9.

FOES

Foes are lesser enemies that often serve as henchmen, lieutenants, and elite soldiers. They're created just like Villains and defined by the same characteristics and narrative elements. However, because these characters haven't quite made it to the big leagues, Foes have only half as much Health as ordinary Heroes and Villains, making them more vulnerable to damage and special effects.

MINIONS

As nameless foot soldiers whose primary role is to fight the Heroes en masse, Minions have only one characteristic: **Threat**. Threat indicates how dangerous these characters are, and is used when making attack rolls, defense rolls, and other combat-related challenge rolls. Minions use only half their Threat when making challenge rolls to detect something, figure something out, or otherwise deal with situations beyond their usual purview. Although some Minions carry special gear or possess unique abilities, these things are always handled narratively.

Creating Minions is as easy as it gets. All the GM has to do is assign a Threat rank, determine how many Minions there are, and note any unique characteristics they possess. When dealing with Minions, every member of the group has the same Threat. That's why they're Minions. Use the **Threat Ranks** table and the unique characteristics that follow as guidelines when creating these characters.

THREAT RANKS

DESCRIPTION	THREAT
Civilians	2d
Bruisers	3d
Professionals	4d
Elites	5d
Enhanced	6d
Super	7d or More

The following unique characteristics are common among comic book Minions. As noted above, they're just guidelines. Feel free to create your own shorthand for your Minions.

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Animals: The Minions are animals. They have enhanced senses, can move faster than ordinary human beings, and/or possess whatever other special abilities make sense for that animal.

Automatons: The Minions possess the Inanimate (Mindless) Power.

Shooters: The Minions can attack enemies within Distant Range.

Unique: The Minions have unique abilities like enhanced senses or flight that would be represented by separate Powers if these characters were Heroes or Villains. In this case, simply describe what they can do.

EXTRAS

Any character run by the GM who isn't a Villain, Foe, or Minion is an Extra. These characters cover a wide range in terms of who they are and how important they are to the game. Extras expected to get involved in the action—whether as allies, enemies, or unaffiliated third parties—should be created and handled like Villains or Foes, depending on how powerful you want them to be. On the other hand, Extras who only serve a narrative role in the game only need to be described in narrative terms. You don't need stat blocks for a Hero's boss or their spouse, much less for the nameless civilians who act as window dressing for the game world and victim-fodder for the Villains. If an unimportant nobody of an Extra suddenly becomes important in the middle of a game because the situation demands it or the players took a shine to them, the GM can stat the character up at that time.



CHARACTER CREATION

The steps to creating characters other than Minions are provided below. Steps 2, 5, and 6 vary depending on whether you are creating a Hero, Villain, Foe, or Extra. As noted above, Minions are simple characters who only have a Threat rank, so these rules don't apply to them.

Step 1: Concept. Come up with a basic idea for the character. If you can't think of anything, try the time-honored tradition of stealing your idea. There are enough out there that finding one you like shouldn't be too difficult. You can create a carbon copy or mine what you find for inspiration.

Step 2: Characteristics. When creating a Hero, spend Hero Points to buy your Abilities, Talents, Powers, and Perks. The GM will tell you how many Hero Points you can spend and the maximum Trait rank you can have, depending on the game's power level (as discussed below). You should also select Flaws; you must have at least one Flaw and can have as many as three to start.

When creating a Villain, Foe, or Extra, simply give them whatever Abilities, Talents, Powers, Perks, and Flaws you consider appropriate. GMs don't have to worry about spending Hero Points or staying within the game's power level and can give these characters as many Flaws as they wish.

Step 3: Gear. Pick the character's mundane gear. Heroes can begin with anything their players want them to have, provided the GM considers it reasonable. Villains, Foes, and Extras, of course, will have whatever gear the GM thinks they should have. You can find mundane gear in Chapter 6.

Step 4: Derived Characteristics. Calculate your Edge, Health, and Resolve. Remember that Foes (and Extras who work like Foes) have half the usual amount of Health, and only Heroes have Resolve.

Step 5: Finishing Touches. Create the details and roleplaying elements that make up your finishing touches. These elements are described later in this chapter. As NPCs, Villains, Foes, and Extras have a different set of finishing touches, found in Chapter 9.

Step 6: Review. Review your Hero with the GM to make sure your character concept and abilities fit the game. If they don't, discuss how you can tweak your Hero to resolve any issues. When creating an NPC, the GM should always review them to be sure they haven't missed anything.

RULE UNO

If you want to break this game, you can. This is a superhero game, one that lets you play anything from an ordinary guy with a serious crime grudge and low impulse control to what can only be described as a demigod. Although we've done our best

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to balance everything, P&P offers an almost infinite number of Power combinations and permutations. That's a lot of ground to cover. As a result, we have Rule Uno:

GMs are the final arbiter of what is allowed in their games, and they can restrict or completely disallow any Power or combination of Powers for any reason whatsoever.

POWER LEVEL

Because superheroes can range from skilled humans to cosmic entities, every series has a **power level** set by the GM. A game's power level determines how many **Hero Points** you have to create your Hero, and the maximum rank you can have in any Trait (the **Trait Cap**). The **Power Levels** table provides starting Hero Points and Trait Caps for the basic power levels. Remember, this only applies to Heroes. The 200 Hero Points listed for Iconic Heroes is a bare minimum for characters of that power level.

POWER LEVELS

POWER LEVEL	HERO POINTS	TRAIT CAP
Street Level	75	8d
Low Level	100	10d
Standard	125	12d
High Level	150	16d
Legendary	175	20d
Iconic	200+	24d

You spend Hero Points to purchase your Abilities, Talents, Powers, and Perks, as discussed below. Note that Heroes with lower Ability and Power ranks begin play with more Resolve, an essential resource in the game. As a result, you may want to keep your Ability and Power ranks below the game's Trait Cap to increase your starting Resolve. Resolve is discussed in more detail in Chapter 5.

Additionally, while there aren't many of them, be careful about Powers that can push otherwise legal Traits above the game's Trait Cap. For example, when using Growth, your Might rank usually increases to match your Growth rank. However, if your Might rank equals or exceeds your Growth rank, your Might rank increases by 1d instead. That isn't normally a problem, unless your Might is maxed out at the game's Trait Cap. If you already have the maximum Might rank allowed, then Growth will push you over the edge. Some GMs will allow this; others won't. Each GM is free to decide whether to allow edge cases like these in their games, so check with yours if this is relevant to you.

ABILITIES, TALENTS AND POWERS

All characters have six **Abilities**: Agility, Intellect, Might, Perception, Toughness, and Willpower. Each costs 1 Hero Point per rank. For example, 3d Agility costs 3 Hero Points. No Ability can have a rank lower than 1d or higher than the game's Trait Cap. Ordinary people have 2d in every Ability.

All characters have twelve **Talents**: Academics, Charm, Command, Covert, Investigation, Medicine, Professional, Science, Streetwise, Survival, Technology, and Vehicles. Each costs 1 Hero Point per rank. For example, 6d Charm costs 6 Hero Points. No Talent can have a rank lower than 1d or higher than the game's Trait Cap. Ordinary people have 2d in every Talent.

Most characters — and certainly all Heroes — have one or more **Powers**. Most Powers cost a number of Hero Points per rank. For example, Flight costs 1 Hero Point per rank, so 10d Flight costs 10 Hero Points. Mind Control, on the other hand, costs 2 Hero Points per rank, so 10d Mind Control costs 20 Hero Points. Some Powers cost 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks. For example, Blind costs that much, so 10d Blind costs 5 Hero Points. When buying Powers that cost 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks, you don't have to take both ranks in the same Power. For example, you can spend 1 Hero Point to buy 1 rank of Evasion and 1 rank of Swimming, two Powers that cost 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks.

Some Powers don't have ranks. Powers like these cost a flat number of Hero Points rather than a number of points per rank. For example, Communications costs 3 Hero Points. There are also Powers that use one of your other Traits as their **baseline rank**. When you buy one of these baseline rank Powers, add your baseline rank to however many ranks of the Power you purchase to determine your final rank. For example, Evasion uses Agility as its baseline rank. If you have 5d Agility and you buy 6 ranks of Evasion, you end up with 11d Evasion. Remember, even when dealing with Powers like these, no Trait can have a rank higher than the game's Trait Cap (subject to optional exceptions discussed in Chapter 9).

PACKAGES

If you want to expedite character creation and save yourself a few Hero Points as well, you can purchase one of the following **packages**. These packages provide you starting Ability and Talents ranks at a small discount. The Civilian Package gives you 2d in all Abilities and Talents. The Hero Package gives you 3d in all Abilities and 2d in all Talents. The Superhero Package gives you 3d in all Abilities and Talents. If you buy one of these packages, you can't lower any of these Traits below these values, but you can raise them as high as you like (subject to the game's Trait Cap) by spending extra Hero Points.

HERO PACKAGES

PACKAGE	BASE RANK	COST
Civilian Package	Abilities 2d Talents 2d	35 Hero Points
Hero Package	Abilities 3d Talents 2d	40 Hero Points
Superhero Package	Abilities 3d Talents 3d	50 Hero Points

PROS AND CONS

Abilities, Talents, and Powers can be modified with options called Pros and Cons. **Pros** are options that make a Trait more effective or powerful, but they cost extra Hero Points. **Cons**, on the other hand, are options that make a Trait less effective or

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powerful, so they save you Hero Points. Pros and Cons usually cost or save you a flat number of points, but a few change a Power's cost per rank. Regardless of Pros and Cons, no Trait can ever cost less than 1 Hero Point (or 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks).

SOURCES

Because Traits can represent so many different things, every Ability, Talent, and Power has a Source that indicates what it's supposed to be: a natural ability, a learned skill, a superpower, a magic spell, etc. The basic Sources are described on the **Sources** table. Abilities are usually Innate, and Talents are usually Trained, at least when dealing with ordinary people. When dealing with supers and characters who aren't human, however, anything goes. For example, a robotic character's Abilities, Talents, and Powers would probably have a Tech Source.

SOURCES

SOURCE	DEFAULT RANK	DESCRIPTION
Innate	Toughness	Shared by all members of a race or species
Magic	Willpower	Magical, divine, infernal, or otherworldly in nature
Psychic	Willpower	Originating from a mental or mystical inner source
Super	Toughness	Caused by a unique alteration or mutation
Tech	Toughness	Mechanical or technological in nature
Trained	Willpower	Developed through practice, study, or training

As noted earlier, some Powers are all-or-nothing abilities that don't have a rank. Your character either has these abilities or they don't. Because these Powers have no rank, they use a **default rank** in place of their rank when dealing with Powers that affect other Powers (such as Power Absorption and Power Mimicry). A Power's default rank varies depending on its Source, as shown on the **Sources** table.

PERKS

Most Perks cost a flat number of Hero Points. For example, Contacts cost 1 Hero Point apiece, while Fame costs 3 Hero Points. A few Perks cost a variable number of Hero Points, depending on how much you want to get out of them. For example, every Hero Point you spend on Headquarters grants you 3 Base Points to spend on your base of operations.

FLAWS

As a starting Hero, you can select up to 3 Flaws. You must select one immediately, but you can leave the other slots open if you prefer, selecting your additional Flaws as ideas come to you. Although you can have fewer than 3 Flaws, this isn't recommended. Not only do Flaws make your character more interesting, they're also one of the easiest ways to earn Resolve. You can spend Hero Points to purchase additional Flaws over time, but you can't have more than 3 at the start.

FINISHING UP

The last part of creating your Hero is just bookkeeping. First, select whatever mundane gear you want to carry around with you. Second, calculate your Edge, Health, and Resolve. Third, complete your finishing touches, the narrative details that turn you into a living, breathing character. And fourth, let the GM review your Hero.

Darlene is going to create a Hero to play in Danny's game. As the GM, Danny informs her that this is going to be a Low Level game. That means Darlene has 100 Hero Points to create her Hero, and the game's Trait Cap is 10d. Darlene already has an idea for the Hero she wants to play, one inspired by a hard-drinking hot mess of a super-powered detective.

Darlene spends 50 Hero Points right off the bat to buy the Superhero Package, giving her 3d in all her Abilities and Traits. She spends 14 more Hero Points on her Abilities: 3 to raise her Agility to 6d, 5 to raise her Might to 8d, 3 to raise her Perception to 6d, and 3 to raise her Toughness to 6d. She also puts 16 more Hero Points into her Talents: 3 to raise her Command to 6d, 3 to raise her Covert to 6d, 7 to raise her Investigation to 10d, and 3 to raise her Streetwise to 6d. Darlene decides that, like most normal people, her Abilities are Innate, and her Talents are Trained. The only exceptions are her Might and Toughness, both of which are Super, the result of a freak accident in her early teens.

With only 20 Hero Points left, Darlene spends 16 of them on her Powers: 5 for 8d Armor (Armor has a baseline rank equal to half her 6d Toughness, or 3d, so she only need to buy 5 ranks of Armor for a final rank of 8d), 5 for one point of Determination, and 6 for Regeneration. Darlene decides that like her Might and Toughness, her Armor and Regeneration Powers are also Super. Determination is a special Power that doesn't have a Source.

Darlene spends her last 4 Hero Points on Contacts, giving her well-connected Hero 4 contacts: a journalist, someone in law enforcement, a local politician, and one lowlife criminal.

With her characteristics out of the way, Darlene doesn't waste a moment coming up with her Flaws, which is what she finds most interesting about this character anyway. Scanning the Flaws, she quickly settles on a Compulsion (drinking), a Quirk (being obnoxious and sarcastic), and a Relationship (with her best friend, someone she's known since high school).

At this point, Darlene chooses her mundane gear, which is easy because she only carries her keys, wallet, and phone around with her (assuming she doesn't forget them at home). She then calculates her Edge, Health, and Resolve and begins to work on her finishing touches. Once she's done, she'll review everything with Danny the GM to make sure her Hero will work for the game he has planned.

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ABILITIES

Abilities represent basic physical and mental characteristics. All characters have six Abilities: Agility, Intellect, Might, Perception, Toughness, and Willpower. The **Ability Ranks** table provides a rough guideline of the relative power levels of Ability ranks 1d to 6d. Ordinary human beings have Ability ranks in this range, with 2d being the average and 6d being the blurry line between exceptional and superhuman. Of course, since comic books are full of supposedly ordinary people with extraordinary abilities, this is more of a rough guideline than a hard cap for ordinary human characters. Even so, ordinary humans almost never have more than 6d Might or Toughness.

ABILITY RANKS

ABILITY	RANK
Impaired	1d
Undeveloped	2d
Developed	3d
Noteworthy	4d
Exceptional	5d
Peak	6d

AGILITY

Agility covers coordination, dexterity, nimbleness, reflexes, and speed. It is used to perform acrobatic or athletic activities like balancing, climbing, diving, jumping, and running. Agility also applies when firing mundane ranged weapons and defending against attacks. Last, you can substitute half your Agility for your Covert when making challenge rolls to hide, move quietly, or avoid detection.

INTELLECT

Intellect represents your intelligence, knowledge, memory, shrewdness, and overall level of education. Use this Trait to make intelligence-based challenge rolls that don't fall under any of your Talents. In fact, you can substitute half your Intellect for any Talent when making challenge rolls to determine what you know about something (but not when trying to actually do anything—knowing how to perform a heart transplant, for example, is very different from actually performing one).

MIGHT

Might is your sheer physical strength. It is used to perform armed and unarmed close combat attacks and feats of strength like lifting heavy objects or tearing things apart. The **Weight** table indicates the maximum amount of weight you can lift, depending on your Might. When not referring to Might, the rank that corresponds to an object's weight on this table is sometimes called its **weight rank**. Last, Might can also come into play when determining your Health.

WEIGHT

RANK	WEIGHT	RANK	WEIGHT
1d	50 pounds	13d	250 tons
2d	100 pounds	14d	500 tons
3d	250 pounds	15d	1 kiloton
4d	500 pounds	16d	2 kilotons
5d	1,000 pounds	17d	5 kilotons
6d	1 ton	18d	10 kilotons
7d	2 tons	19d	25 kilotons
8d	5 tons	20d	50 kilotons
9d	10 tons	21d	100 kilotons
10d	25 tons	22d	250 kilotons
11d	50 tons	23d	500 kilotons
12d	100 tons	24d	1 megaton

THE BRUTE OPTION

Some characters are much stronger than they are skilled in combat. If that describes you, you can apply the **Overkill** Con to Might. This unique Con lets you buy Might at half price: you pay 1 Hero Point for every 2 ranks of Might. However, whenever an opponent uses an active defense against your close combat attacks (armed or unarmed), their successes are doubled. Additionally, if you select this option, you use only half your Might rather than your full Might when determining your baseline rank for Powers like Martial Arts and Strike.

PERCEPTION

Perception covers your sensory acuity, empathy, intuition, and overall level of awareness. It's used any time you need to detect or discern hidden things, from assailants to clues to intentions. It also indicates how quickly you can detect, process, and react to new information.

TOUGHNESS

Toughness combines your constitution, endurance, and physical resilience. It's used to resist Powers that affect you physically, as well as physical agents or toxins like diseases, drugs, and poisons. Last, Toughness helps determine how much Health you have and how quickly you recover from injuries.

WILLPOWER

Willpower represents your courage, determination, and self-discipline. It also indicates the power of your spirit or psyche. It's used to defend against Powers that affect the mind or soul, and to resist negative emotions and impulses. It can also come into play when determining your Health.

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TALENTS

Talents represent natural aptitudes and skills picked up through experience or training. All characters have twelve Talents: Academics, Charm, Command, Covert, Investigation, Medicine, Professional, Science, Streetwise, Survival, Technology, and Vehicles. Simply possessing these Talents doesn't mean you have actual training or experience, not unless you have a rank of 3d or better (and maybe not even then). The **Talent Ranks** table provides a rough guideline of the relative level of experience, knowledge, or proficiency represented by Talent ranks 1d to 6d. Generally speaking, ordinary human beings have Talent ranks within this range, with 2d being the untrained average, 4d being the average for someone with training or experience, and 6d being the blurry line between exceptional and superhuman. As with Abilities, this is more a rough guideline than a hard cap for ordinary human characters.

TALENT RANKS

TALENT	RANK
Clueless	1d
Unskilled	2d
Proficient	3d
Advanced	4d
Expert	5d
Master	6d

Talents are supposed to be unrealistically broad, covering a huge variety of disciplines and skills. If you want to tamp this down, you can assume that a Talent's rank also determines the breadth of your expertise. As a general rule, a rank of 1d to 3d means you have everyday knowledge and expertise, a rank of 4d to 6d indicates uncommon knowledge and expertise, and a rank of 7d or higher represents esoteric knowledge and expertise. For example, it's reasonable to assume you know how to drive a car with a Vehicles rank of 1d to 3d, a helicopter or an airplane with a Vehicles rank of 4d to 6d, and an experimental prototype starfighter with a Vehicles rank of 7d or higher.

ACADEMICS

Academics represents knowledge of scholarly subjects like anthropology, archaeology, art, cultures, history, linguistics, philosophy, psychology, and sociology. It also covers esoteric and fantastical topics like dimensional geography, interplanetary news, magic, the occult, mythical beings, creatures, and places, and so on. If you have at least 4d in this Talent, you are highly educated or well-read.

CHARM

Charm reflects attractiveness, empathy, social skills, and force of personality. You use this Talent whenever you try to bluff, charm, deceive, negotiate with, persuade, or seduce someone. Acting also falls under Charm, even when you aren't using it to deceive anyone.

COMMAND

Command concerns getting others to do what you want through force of will. Use this Talent whenever you try to command, frighten, intimidate, interrogate, motivate, or order people around. Apart from that, Command also covers establishing and understanding command structures and protocols.

COVERT

Covert applies to intrusion, larceny, shadowing, stealth, and surveillance. It's used whenever you need to hide, move quietly, follow someone, conduct covert surveillance, or otherwise avoid detection. Covert also helps defeat security measures like alarms, cameras, locks, and traps, as well as to palm items, pick pockets, and perform other acts of nimble-fingered larceny.

INVESTIGATION

Investigation concerns the ability to conduct investigations, uncover clues, perform research, interrogate witnesses, analyze data, and make deductive or intuitive leaps. If you have at least 4d in this Talent, you are well-versed in police procedures and your investigations may be admissible in court.

MEDICINE

Medicine covers academic and clinical knowledge of medicine and psychology. Assuming you have medical supplies on hand, you can treat wounded characters by making a Hard (2) Medicine roll, healing them of 1 point of damage per net success rolled. Raise the difficulty to Daunting (3) when treating yourself. You can only do this once per patient per day (or once per patient per week if using the Gritty Combat Rules in Chapter 4). If you have at least 4d in this Talent, you are probably a trained doctor. Your parents must be very proud.

PROFESSIONAL

Professional reflects your knowledge of the professional world and covers topics like business, economics, and finance. While you may also have a basic understanding of more specific professional areas such as accounting, journalism, law, marketing, politics, or public relations, the Expertise Power represents in-depth knowledge of a specific professional career.

SCIENCE

Science covers your knowledge of scientific topics including disciplines like astronomy, biology, botany, chemistry, ecology, genetics, geology, metallurgy, oceanography, physics, and quantum mechanics. It also covers esoteric or fantastical science like paranormal biology or the unique laws of physics in Dimension X! If you have at least 4d in this Talent, you are probably a trained scientist.

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STREETWISE

Streetwise represents your knowledge of important locations, personalities, and happenings in the criminal underworld, as well as your ability to interact with them. If you have at least 4d in this Talent, your parents probably aren't nearly as proud as they would have been if you'd gone to med school.

SURVIVAL

Survival concerns your ability to survive in the wild. It's used when building fires, finding food and water, securing shelter, setting traps and snares, tracking, and so on. It also covers practical information about plants and animals found in the wild. Last, this Talent applies when handling animals or riding mounts. If you have at least 4d in this Talent, you may also know how to care for, tame, and train animals.

TECHNOLOGY

Technology deals with the creation, modification, and repair of mechanical and technological devices of every kind. This includes computers, electronics, machines, robots, steampunk technology, vehicles, weapons, and anything else you can think of. It also covers the use (and misuse) of high-tech systems like computers and computer networks, as well as equipment like communications and sensor systems. Assuming you have the right tools, you can repair damaged objects by making a Hard (2) Technology roll, repairing 1 point of damage per net success rolled. You can only do this once per object per day.

VEHICLES

Vehicles covers the ability to operate all sorts of vehicles. It applies not only to piloting, but also to gunnery, navigation, operations, and even basic maintenance. As mentioned earlier, it might be reasonable to assume you can only drive ordinary vehicles like cars and motorcycles unless you have at least 4d in this Talent, but the GM always has the final say on this.

POWERS

Powers are unique special abilities. Some are rather generic, while others are quite specific. This is by design. The generic Powers are there to let you create any ability you can imagine. The specific ones are there so you don't have to jump through hoops to create an iconic superpower that everyone recognizes. Whether generic or specific, each Power's entry includes its range, rank, cost, and description. Many also include specific Pros and Cons applicable only to that Power.

Range: Powers have a range of Self, Touch, Ranged, Zone, or Special. **Self** means the Power affects you. **Touch** means the Power affects beings and/or objects you touch, so they have to be adjacent to you or at least within Close Range so you can move up to them. **Ranged** means the Power affects beings and/or objects within Distant Range. **Zone** is the only range option that incorporates an area of effect, and means the Power always affects everyone and/or everything within 5 to 25 feet of you—you decide how far to extend the Zone each time you use the Power. Last, a few Powers with a range of **Special** work in some unique way discussed in their descriptions.

Rank: This indicates whether the Power has a rank. **Power Rank** means it does. **Baseline Rank (X)** also means the Power has a rank, but in this case, the Trait used to determine the Power's baseline rank is noted in parentheses. When you buy a Power with a baseline rank, add the baseline rank to the number of ranks you purchase to determine the Power's final rank. **Default Rank** means the power doesn't have a rank. You use your Toughness or Willpower (it varies by Source) in place of the Power's rank when dealing with Powers that affect other Powers. Last, a few Powers with a rank of **Special** work in some unique way discussed in their descriptions.



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POWERS

Adaptation
Alternate Form
Animal Control
Animal Empathy
Animal Mimicry
Animation
Armor
Astral Projection
Attuned
Aura
Banish
Blast
Blending
Blind
Blind Fighting
Blink
Boost
Buff
Clairvoyance
Cloud Minds
Communications
Constructs
Danger Sense
Darkness
Dazzle
Deflection
Density
Detection
Determination
Dimensional Travel
Dispel
Drain
Duplication
Elemental Control
Emotion Control
Energy Absorption
Ensnare
Evasion
Expertise
Extra Limbs
Flight
Force Field
Form
Gestalt
Growth
Hard to Kill
Healing
Hibernation
Hyper Breath
Illusions
Immortality
Immunity
Inanimate
Invisibility
Irritant
Languages
Leadership
Leaping
Life Drain
Light/Effect
Lightning Reflexes
Luck
Machine Control
Martial Arts
Master of Disguise
Matter Chameleon
Mind Blast
Mind Control
Nullify
Omni-Power
Phasing
Plasticity
Polymorph
Portable Storehouse
Possession
Power Absorption
Power Mimicry
Precognition
Preparation
Psi-Screen
Psychometry
Quick Change
Radar
Regeneration
Resistance
Running
Separation
Shockwave
Shrinking
Slay
Slick
Speak with Dead
Specialty
Spinning
Star Gate
Stretching
Strike
Stun
Summoning
Super Senses
Super Speed
Swimming
Swing Line
Telekinesis
Telepathy
Teleportation
Time Stop
Time Travel
Total Recall
Tracer
Transformation
Transmutation
Tunneling
Two-Dimensional
Two-Fisted
Vanish
Variant
Ventriloquism
Wall-Crawling
Weakness Detection

SUPER TIP!

Remember that the best superhero stories aren't about having superpowers. They're about doing the right thing, especially when that thing is dangerous, hard, scary, or requires sacrifice. Don't let all these superpowers distract you; your games should be about people who are also superheroes rather than about superheroes who are also people.

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A Power's rank is normally used to make challenge rolls. It also helps determine what or how much you can do with a Power. For example, Powers that can move physical objects can usually affect up to the amount you could lift with a Might equal to your Power rank. Unless a Power's description says otherwise, don't apply its rank to anything other than what the Power does. For example, neither Flight nor Teleportation specify that your Power rank determines how much you can carry while using those Powers, so that amount is determined as usual (i.e., by your Might).

If you have a Power that lets you move faster than normal or in ways an ordinary person can't (a **Travel Power**), your Power rank usually indicates your maximum speed, as shown on the **Speed** table. Ordinary people move at 3d speed, sound travels at 9d, and light clocks in at a brisk 27d. The rank that corresponds to an object's speed on this table is sometimes called its **speed rank**.

SPEED

RANK	MPH	RANK	MPH
1d	2	13d	25,000
2d	5	14d	50,000
3d	10	15d	100,000
4d	25	16d	250,000
5d	50	17d	500,000
6d	100	18d	1 million
7d	250	19d	2 million
8d	500	20d	5 million
9d	1,000	21d	10 million
10d	2,500	22d	25 million
11d	5,000	23d	50 million
12d	10,000	24d	100 million

Cost: This indicates how much the Power costs, whether a flat amount or a cost per rank. No Power can ever cost less than 1 Hero Point (or 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks) regardless of its Cons. A few Powers with a cost of **Special** work in some unique way discussed in their descriptions.

Description: This describes what the Power does and how it works. If a Power can be used to attack or affect other characters, its description indicates the Traits that may be used to resist such efforts. The defender always uses whichever Trait offers them the best chance of success when making challenge rolls to resist a Power. Occasionally, a Power's description may also include notes concerning its use and suggestions to the GM regarding what effect it may have on the game.

ADAPTATION

Self • Default Rank • 12 Hero Points

Your body instantly adapts to your surroundings, letting you breathe, move around, sense things, and survive in alien or hostile environments. For example, you might grow gills, fins, and a membrane over your eyes while underwater, plus you'd become immune to undersea pressure and temperature.

ALTERNATE FORM

Self • Default Rank • 4 Hero Points per power level

You can turn into a different form. Create this form as a separate Hero (see below). Your alternate form can be of any power level up to but not higher than yours. For example, if you are a Standard Hero, your other form can be Street Level, Low Level, or Standard. This Power's cost varies depending on your other form's power level, as indicated on the **Alternate Form** table. Your other form's power level only affects the number of Hero Points you have to create it, not its Trait Cap. Both forms must pay for this Power. As you gain extra Hero Points, you can spend them differently for each form. Buy this Power multiple times if you want multiple forms, but each form must pay this Power's total cost. For example, if you buy this Power twice to gain 2 alternate Standard forms, all three forms will have to pay the 24 Hero Points.

When creating alternate forms, you must give them their own their Abilities, Talents, and Powers, although some of these Traits may share the same rank across multiple forms. Your various forms may share Perks and Flaws, or they might have their own. This varies by character. No matter how many forms you can assume, you only have one pool of Resolve: use the lowest Resolve among your various forms as your actual Resolve. For example, if you have two forms, one that would have 6 Resolve as a separate character and one that would have 1 Resolve as a separate character, you have 1 Resolve.

ALTERNATE FORM

POWER LEVEL	COST
Street Level	4
Low Level	8
Standard	12
High Level	16
Legendary	20
Iconic	24

CON **Independent Forms (–1 per power level):** Each of your forms has a separate identity, memory, and personality, and your various forms may or may not get along very well.

ANIMAL CONTROL

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

Whether through mind control or friendly communication, you can make animals do what you want for the Power's duration by making an Animal Control roll against their Willpower.

PRO **Calling (+2):** You can call out to distant animals, which lets you use this Power on creatures within Extreme Range (basically as far as your call can be heard). Controlled animals race to your location, and the Power's duration doesn't begin to run until they arrive.

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CON **Only X (–2 or –4):** You can only control a specific category, group, or type of animal specified when you buy this Power. This is normally a –2 Con, but if the group of animals is very narrow or of limited utility (such as aquatic animals), this becomes a –4 Con instead.

ANIMAL EMPATHY

Self • Default Rank • 1 Hero Point

You share an empathic understanding with animals. Animals are unlikely to attack you without good reason, such as if they're injured or protecting their young, and even then, you may be able to dissuade them (especially if you have snacks because, well, because snacks).

PRO **Speech (+2):** You can communicate with animals. GMs determine how intelligent mundane animals are in their games and how they react to this. One could reasonably assume that domesticated animals and those comfortable with humans are usually friendly unless trained to be otherwise, but wild animals are likely much more cautious.

ANIMAL MIMICRY

Self • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can mimic animals, gaining their Powers at the lower of their Power rank or your Power rank. When mimicking an animal, you gain all their Powers, even ones that would seem to rely on body parts you lack (claws, gills, wings, etc.). You also gain the animal's Agility, Might, Perception, and Toughness at the lesser of their respective Ability ranks or your Power rank, but only if their Ability ranks exceed yours. If any of your Abilities are greater, they aren't affected. You can mimic any natural animal you are familiar with, whether alive or extinct. As for magical creatures like dragons and unicorns, that's up to the GM. If you are an alien, you mimic alien animals. For the sake of game balance (and everyone's sanity), these alien animals look different but have the same characteristics as the Earth animals described in Chapter 8. Mimicking an animal or changing your selection is a free action, but you can only do so once per page, twice if you forego your next turn to act.

PRO **Enhanced (+4):** Whenever you mimic an animal, you can use your Power rank in place of its highest ranked Trait. You can do this for only one Trait per animal (pick one if several Traits have the same rank). For example, gorillas have 6d Might and Toughness. If you use 10d Animal Mimicry to mimic a gorilla, you can give yourself 10d in one of those Abilities.

PRO **Selection (+4):** You can mimic more than one animal at a time, using the best Traits from among all the animals you are mimicking, but this lowers your effective Power rank by 1d per extra animal being mimicked at the same time.

ANIMATION

Ranged • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can animate images and objects, bringing them to life until the end of the scene or until you dismiss them. Animated images step off the page, screen, wall, or surface on which you found them and grow to their actual real-world size. Animated objects, meanwhile, begin moving in whatever way seems most natural: statues twist and bend as if their joints were real, flexible objects move like snakes, solid objects gain a cartoonish level of flexibility that allows them to move around, weapons leap into the air as if wielded by invisible enemies, and so on.

Animated beings have three Abilities, Agility, Might, and Toughness, plus whatever Powers they should reasonably possess. For example, an animated image of a winged dragon should probably have Blast (Fire) and Flight (whether or not the image was breathing fire or flying), while an animated marble statue should probably have Solid Form. One of your creation's Traits shares this Power's rank; the rest have a rank equal to half your Animation rank. You determine which Trait uses your full Power rank on a case-by-case basis. Animated beings are inanimate objects that lack mental faculties and act only in response to your mental commands. You can animate more than one thing at a time, but this lowers your effective Animation rank by 1d per extra object. You can't animate a physical object whose Structure exceeds your Power rank.

ARMOR

Self • Baseline Rank (½ Toughness) • 1 Hero Point per rank

You have armor or a personal force field that repels damage. You can use this Power as a passive defense against physical attacks and energy attacks, regardless of the type of damage they inflict. You are completely immune to such attacks if their attack rank is less than or equal to half your Armor rank (unless they have the Penetrating Pro). When dealing with Minions, use their unmodified Threat rank as their attack rank when determining if you are immune to their attacks.

CON **Activated (–1):** This Power represents a defense you must activate, like a personal force shield or body coating. Although you can do this as a free action, the Power stops working if you are knocked out or otherwise rendered unconscious.

CON **Reactive (–2):** This Power represents something like bracers or a shield that you use to block or deflect incoming attacks. Accordingly, it's considered an active defense.

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ASTRAL PROJECTION

Self • Default Rank • 12 Hero Points

Your astral form can leave your physical body. You gain Invisible, Phasing (Intangible), and Super Senses (Astral Sight) while in astral form, although you can make yourself visible if you wish. You can also fly in this form, as if you had Flight at your Willpower rank. As long as you are using this Power, your physical body lies dormant, although you will know instantly if it gets moved or harmed.

ATTUNED

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You are attuned to some aspect of nature like currents and tides, plate tectonics, or weather patterns, to a particular geographic area like a city, forest, jungle, or sacred grove, or to the larger cosmos in general. You can tell when dramatic or unusual disturbances or phenomenon are imminent within your area of attunement. If attuned to a geographic area, you can also tell when powerful beings enter or leave, possibly even when they're born and when they die, depending on how powerful they are. Your level of sensitivity varies depending on the scope of your attunement. For example, a magician attuned to the mansion that serves as her *sanctum sanctorum* is keenly aware of everything that happens in her home, while a cosmically attuned galactic guardian is only sensitive to cosmic beings, events, and forces. This Power automatically provides you with basic information, but you can spend 1 Resolve to ask the GM for more in-depth information, assuming there's any to be had. The information you receive may sometimes be incomplete or misleading, but it is always truthful.

AURA

Self • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

Your body inflicts a specific type of energy damage on contact (pick one). Anyone who touches you suffers an attack using your Aura rank that can only be resisted with passive defenses. This also applies to anyone who strikes you in unarmed combat (if you resist an unarmed attack with a passive defense, assume the attacker strikes you, even if you suffer no damage). You can also use Aura to perform close combat attacks that inflict energy damage. If you already have a close combat attack at an equal or greater rank, use its rank +1d instead. Physical objects tend to burn, dissolve, or melt near you, so you suffer no damage from mundane physical objects with a Structure lower than your Aura rank. Wooden weapons usually have 6d Structure, while bullets and metal weapons usually have 9d Structure.

CON **Spines (–2):** Your body has a covering of quills or spines that inflict physical damage rather than energy damage. As a result, this Power provides no protection against physical attacks.

BANISH

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can banish a target to another time, place, or dimension (pick one) by making a Banish roll against their Willpower or one of their active defenses. If you wish, you can specify that your version of the Power is resisted with Toughness instead of Willpower, but active defenses always apply as well. You can't send targets anywhere that would be harmful or from which they can't return, but characters run by an evil GM have no

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such restrictions, and all GMs are evil. Even though a banished target isn't actually present, you can keep using this Power on them until they've been defeated — in this case, you aren't so much attacking as concentrating on keeping them away — but the effect is the same.

When Heroes get banished, they often wind up in dangerous or at least interesting locales. Banished Heroes still get their actions, which they can use to fight off hungry monsters, explore strange alien vistas, or do whatever else is appropriate for the place in which they find themselves.

BLAST

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can fire a damaging ranged attack. You must specify the kind of damage inflicted when you buy this Power (unless you apply the Weapons Con discussed below).

PRO **Block (+2):** You can use the Power as an active defense against ranged physical and energy attacks (but not against area attacks) by shooting them down. If you forego your next action, this turns the attack into a **blast duel**, a 3-exchange contest, with each character using their Blast Power against the other. The first exchange happens immediately. The second happens on your next turn to act. The third and final exchange happens on your opponent's next turn to act. Whoever wins the contest hits their opponent with a number of successes equal to their Blast rank, and this attack can only be resisted with passive defenses.

PRO **Melee (+2):** You can use the Power as an active defense against close combat attacks. The Power may look different when used in this fashion. For example, your fire Blast might take on the appearance of a flaming sword whenever you get into close combat.

CON **Subdual (–1):** The Power inflicts subdual damage.

CON **Weapons (–1):** This Power represents mastery of a group of weapons as broad or narrow as you like — the level of specificity doesn't matter. You have to be armed with that type of weapon to use the Power. This lets you use your Blast rank (instead of your Ability plus Weapon Bonus) to make attack rolls while so armed. Otherwise, the weapon works as usual and deals whatever type of damage it normally inflicts.

BLENDING

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

Your coloring can change to match your environment, granting you a +3d bonus on Covert rolls to avoid being seen. If you remain still, you can also make a Covert roll at half your rank (after taking the +3d bonus into account) to avoid being seen when you would otherwise be in plain view.

BLIND

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks

You can blind a living target for the Power's duration by making a Blind roll against their Toughness or one of their active defenses. Targets affected by this Power suffer a –3d penalty to their attack and active defense rolls in combat unless they have a Power like Blind Fighting or Radar that compensates for this. You can have a version of Blind that affects a sense other than vision, but you and the GM will have to determine whether this has any mechanical effect in combat.

BLIND FIGHTING

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You don't rely on vision in combat. As a result, you suffer no penalties or adverse effects when fighting in the dark or against opponents you can't see, whatever the reason.

BLINK

Self • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You use your Powers to blink in and out of reality during combat. This can mean any number of things: phasing in and out of the physical world, rapidly changing your size and/or shape, sliding through dimensional portals, teleporting around opponents, or anything else you can image. Use Blink instead of Might when making close combat attack rolls and instead of Agility when making active defense rolls and movement rolls (although this isn't a Travel Power and doesn't actually let you move any faster than normal). If you have these Traits or other applicable Powers (such as Evasion, Martial Arts, or Strike) at an equal or greater rank, use their ranks +1d instead.

BOOST

Self • Baseline Rank (Special) • Special

You can raise the rank of one specific Ability, Talent, or Power (pick one) up to this Power's rank. This Power costs as many Hero Points per rank as the Trait it affects and uses that Trait as its baseline rank. Cons must be applied to this Power to indicate how and when it operates; otherwise it's meaningless.

CON **Rage (–2):** The Power activates when you get really mad. However, your Intellect and all your Talents drop to 1d as long as you remain angry enough to use this Power. Your rage always subsides by the end of a scene. You should also consider the Quirk (Bad Temper) Flaw.

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BUFF

Zone • Default Rank • 12 Hero Points

You can spend 1 point of Resolve to bolster yourself and all allies within range, granting you all a +1d bonus on all challenge rolls for the rest of the scene. Your allies must remain within the Power's area of effect to get this bonus. You must use an action to activate this Power, but once you do, you can sustain it as a free action. This Power always expires at the end of a scene, if not sooner. Buff can't be stacked, not even if multiple characters have it from different Sources.

PRO **Greater (6):** You can increase the bonus provided by this Power by +1d per extra point of Resolve spent, up to a maximum of 3 points of Resolve for a +3d bonus. Certain NPCs may be able to push this envelope, but that's within the GM's purview.

CLAIRVOYANCE

Self • Default Rank • 9 Hero Points

You can see things at distant locations as if you were there. If the location is somehow shielded from you, you must make a Willpower roll against the shielding rank to use this Power. Clairvoyance works at any distance. You can even peer into other dimensions by making a Superhuman (6) Willpower roll. Although you normally observe locations, you can instead focus on a specific person or object. To do this, you must be familiar with the subject or have some meaningful item or fetish that connects you. This won't tell you where that subject is located unless something you see gives that away.

CLOUD MINDS

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can cloud the minds of living beings, effectively making yourself invisible to everyone within Distant Range. Characters affected by this Power can't see, hear, or otherwise detect you in any way unless they make a successful Willpower roll against your Cloud Minds. Characters cannot attempt to resist this Power unless you move within Close Range of them or take some action that would make your presence evident. You must spend 1 action per page to maintain this Power.

COMMUNICATIONS

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You can detect, receive, store, and transmit communications and information across whatever networks exist in your game. Your range is worldwide or farther if it makes sense in the game world. Although you can interface with mundane communication systems, you don't require physical infrastructure like cell towers or communication satellites. This Power works automatically, but you may have to make Technology rolls to do things like tap into secure networks or channels.

CONSTRUCTS

Ranged • Power Rank • 3 Hero Points per rank

You can create and manipulate constructs of solid force. You can create simple geometric shapes and physical objects like airfoils, balls, bars, cages, columns, crowbars, hammers, hands, nets, parachutes, ramps, ropes, walls, wedges, and so on. Your constructs have a Structure equal to your Power rank and can be as rigid or as flexible as you like. You can use them to grab, lift, or exert force with an effective Might equal to your Constructs rank. You have complete control over your constructs, and can alter their size, shape, and rigidity as desired. You can use this Power to attack targets in any number of ways such as by creating constructs in the air above them and letting them drop, flinging them at your targets like projectiles, and so on. You can also defend yourself against physical and energy attacks by creating momentary shields and walls. Your constructs last for the rest of the scene, until you dispel them, or until they're destroyed. You can create and control multiple constructs at one time, but this lowers your effective rank by 1d per extra construct and you still suffer the usual multiple action penalties if you perform more than one action per page.

PRO **Devices (+2 per rank):** You can create complex machines and intricate shapes that can imitate other Powers. This works like a broad version of Omni-Power.

DANGER SENSE

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 1 Hero Point per rank

You have the uncanny ability to detect immediate physical danger, even from sources you have no way of sensing, like a bomb under the floor. Use this Power instead of Perception when making rolls to detect danger and when determining your Edge. Additionally, you can make active defense rolls even when caught by surprise, using the lesser of your active defense rank or your Danger Sense rank.

DARKNESS

Zone • Default Rank • 6 Hero Points

You can fill the space around you with darkness, dust, fog, smoke, or some other obscuring element through which only you and those unaffected by the obscuring element can see. Make up the specifics when you select this Power. For example, Super Senses (Night Vision or Thermal Vision) might let you see through darkness, while Super Senses (Thermal Vision or Ultra Vision) might let you see through fog or smoke. Targets affected by this Power suffer a –3d penalty to their attack and active defense rolls in combat unless they have a Power like Blind Fighting or Radar that compensates for this.

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DAZZLE

Zone • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can emit a blinding flash that overwhelms the senses of all living beings within range, friend and foe alike, by making a Dazzle roll against their Willpower or one of their active defenses. Targets affected by this Power are stunned for one page (until after your next turn to act) and then blinded for whatever's left of the Power's duration. Stunned targets cannot move or perform actions. Blinded targets are affected as per Blind. Unlike most Powers, you can't use this on a target already suffering from its effects, so you can't stack the duration by attacking the same target multiple times.

CON **Deafen (–1):** The Power leaves targets deafened rather than blinded after the stun effect wears off. Although preferable to being blinded, deafened characters are disoriented and suffer a –1d penalty on all challenge rolls for the rest of the Power's duration. The GM will have to decide if characters with Powers like Blind Fighting or Radar can ignore this penalty.

DEFLECTION

Self • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can deflect and redirect ranged attacks (but not area attacks). Decide whether you can deflect physical attacks or energy attacks when you select this Power. You can use your Deflection rank as an active defense against that type of attack. Whenever such an attack fails to harm you, you can spend a free action to immediately redirect it using the lesser of the attack's rank or your Deflection rank to make your attack roll. You can deflect any number of attacks without penalty, but you suffer a cumulative –2d penalty on your rolls to redirect these attacks if you try to redirect two or more on the same page. If you wish, you can double the cost of this Power and spend 2 Hero Points per rank to be able to deflect both physical attacks and energy attacks.

CON **Only X (–4):** You can only deflect one specific type of object or energy (pick one).

DENSITY

Self • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can increase your density. While dense, you can substitute your current Density rank for your Might and Toughness, and you gain Armor at that rank as well. If you already have any of these Traits at an equal or greater rank, use their ranks +1d instead. You also become heavier when using this Power: at rank 3d or higher, your weight rank equals your current Density rank. Most ordinary floors will have trouble supporting your weight much past 6d Density.

DETECTION

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks

You can detect the presence and pinpoint the location of something: a particular type of energy or matter, a certain kind of being or object, a specific emotion or mental state, life, death, taxes, or whatever else you want. This Power normally works automatically, but you may have to make challenge rolls using your Power rank to detect things that are faint, hidden, or otherwise hard to notice. Unlike most ranged Powers, Detection works out to Extreme Range.

PRO **Long Range (+1):** The Power works at incredible and possibly interplanetary distances. In effect, it extends as far as the Heroes need, out to the very limits of Plot Device Range.

DETERMINATION

Self • Special • 5 Hero Points per 1 Resolve

Your determination is legendary, even for a Hero. You begin every issue with 1 extra point of Resolve for every 5 Hero Points you put into Determination. This Power has no rank and can't be absorbed, drained, mimicked, or affected by other abilities. Only Heroes can make use of this power.

DIMENSIONAL TRAVEL

Self • Default Rank • 6 Hero Points

You can travel to other dimensions. Although it involves travel, you must spend an action to use this Power. The first time you travel to an unfamiliar dimension, you arrive at a random location determined by the GM. After that, you return to where you were when you left, or you can spend 1 Resolve to arrive at another familiar location of your choosing. You can use this Power a number of times per issue equal to your Willpower without paying anything. Each use after that costs 1 Resolve.

PRO **Portal (+2):** You can create portals through which others can travel.

DISPEL

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks

You can free a being or object within range from the effect of any Power that has an ongoing duration by making a Dispel roll against that Power's rank. You can only dispel Powers from one Source (pick one). This doesn't prevent a Power from working; it merely ends the Power's duration. However, you can use Dispel as an active defense against Powers that inflict special effects.

PRO **Also X (Special):** You can dispel Powers from more than one Source. Every additional Source increases this Power's cost by 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks. For example, this Power costs 1 Hero Point per rank if you can dispel Magic and Psychic Powers.

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DRAIN

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks

You can drain a character's Abilities, Talents, and Powers from a specific Source (pick one) by making a Drain roll against their highest-ranked Trait that shares this Source. Drained Abilities and Talents drop to 1d for the Power's duration, while drained Powers completely stop working. Abilities, Talents, and Powers from other Sources are unaffected and can't be used to resist this Power.

PRO **Also X (Special):** You can affect Traits from more than one Source. Every additional Source increases this Power's cost by 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks. For example, this Power costs 3 Hero Points per 2 ranks if you can affect Innate, Super, and Trained Traits.

CON **Only X (–2 or –4):** You can only affect one type of Trait. This is usually a –2 Con and means you can only affect Abilities, Talents, or Powers (pick one). If you can only affect one specific Ability, Talent, or Power (again, pick one), this is a –4 Con instead.

DUPLICATION

Self • Default Rank • 25 Hero Points

You can spend an action to create a duplicate of yourself. Your duplicate is an exact copy of you but lacks this Power. This doesn't grant you extra uses of Powers with limited uses like Dimensional Travel or Healing. Although you can both use these Powers, each use is tallied against their limit. Your duplicate lacks Resolve, but you can spend yours on their behalf. Your duplicate vanishes when either of you is defeated. Once they vanish, a duplicate can't be summoned again in the same scene.

You can buy this Power multiple times if you want to be able to create multiple duplicates. Because this Power effectively gives you an extra character to control, GMs should feel free to limit or prohibit its use.

ELEMENTAL CONTROL

Ranged • Power Rank • 3 Hero Points per rank

You can create and control one type of energy, matter, or phenomenon (called an **element**). Common elements include air, cold, earth and stone, electricity, fire, friction, garbage, gravity, heat, ice, light, magnetism, metal, plants, plasma, radiation, sand, sound, vibrations, water, weather, and wood. By manipulating this element, you can create effects that imitate other Powers at this Power's rank, provided what you are doing makes comic book sense. In effect, this Power works like Constructs and/or a narrow version of Omni-Power, depending on what you can control.

PRO **Matter Creation (+1 per rank):** Matter created with this power is normally unstable, dissolving or dissipating by the end of the scene (as per Constructs). However, you can create stable matter that will last as long as ordinary matter of its type by spending an amount of Resolve equal to the weight rank of the stable matter you wish to create (minimum 1 point). You must be able to control a type of matter to select this Pro.

CON **Only Control (–1 per rank):** You can control the element, but you can't create it. Instead, you must rely on whatever is available within range.



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EMOTION CONTROL

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can cause anyone within range to experience an overwhelming emotion or mental state such as anger, confusion, fear, love, lust, or sadness by making an Emotion Control roll against their Willpower. The GM determines how the target reacts based on the circumstances and the feeling generated, but the emotion can run from mild to overwhelming and the reaction is often powerful and irrational.

CON **Only X (–2):** You can only generate one emotion or mental state (pick one).

CON **Pheromones (–2):** Your Power is chemical in nature. Characters use the greater of their Toughness or Willpower to resist it. Additionally, characters who don't breathe are immune to this Power, as are those protected by life support systems or immune to toxins.

ENERGY ABSORPTION

Self • Power Rank • 1 or 3 Hero Points per rank

You can absorb one type of energy (pick one) by siphoning it from a nearby source or getting struck by an attack. You absorb a number of ranks equal to the lesser of the energy's rank or your Power rank. You are immune to energy attacks with a rank less than or equal to your Power rank, and you can use this Power as a passive defense against energy attacks with a greater rank. Absorbed energy must be spent immediately in one of the following ways. It can boost your Agility, Might, or Toughness to the rank of the absorbed energy until the end of the following page. It can grant you a +1d bonus to all rolls until the end of the following page. It can be fired out as a Blast at the rank of the absorbed energy. Or it can heal one point of damage for every 2 full ranks absorbed. Energy Absorption costs 1 Hero Point per rank unless you can absorb kinetic energy (i.e., all physical attacks), in which case it costs 3 Hero Points per rank and is subject to the GM's approval.

PRO **Also X (+2):** You can absorb one extra type of energy (other than kinetic energy) each time you select this Pro. This Pro cannot be used to add kinetic energy to this Power after the fact.

SUPER TIP!

P&P is not a granular, skill-based game, but you can use Expertise to much the same effect by ruling that characters must have an appropriate Expertise in certain instances.

ENSNARE

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can ensnare an opponent in something like ice, vines, or webbing that prevents them from taking physical actions for the Power's duration by making an Ensnare roll against their Might or one of their active defenses. Targets can also use Aura as a passive defense against this attack.

PRO **Line (+2):** This power involves some sort of line or tether that lets you pull an ensnared target to you as long as their weight rank doesn't exceed your Ensnare rank. If your target weighs more than you can lift, however, you may be the one moving.

CON **Immobilize (–2):** You only glue targets to one spot. Targets can't move from their current location, but they remain free to take whatever other physical actions they wish.

EVASION

Self • Baseline Rank (Agility) • 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks

You are a nimble combatant who's always in motion. You can use Evasion instead of Agility when making active defense rolls and movement rolls (although this isn't a Travel Power and doesn't actually let you move any faster than normal). You can also use Evasion in place of Agility when performing or resisting combat stunts.

EXPERTISE

Self • Baseline Rank (Special) • 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks

You have a specialization of some kind, often a specific area of knowledge, proficiency, or skill. Your specialization must fall under one of your Abilities or Talents. Make up the specialization and specify which Trait it falls under when you select this Power. For example, you could have Expertise (Agility: Firearms) or Expertise (Technology: Robotics). The same specialization may fall under more than one Trait (for example, a military science specialty could reasonably fall under Academics or Professional). Use this Power's rank in place of the Trait your Expertise falls under whenever your specialization applies. This Power's baseline rank equals the rank of the Ability or Talent it falls under.

EXTRA LIMBS

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You have extra arms, prehensile hair, a prehensile tail, tentacles, or something similar. Aside from the numerous advantages of having extra manipulative limbs, you gain a +2d bonus to your attack and defense rolls when grappling. The GM may also let you apply this bonus to other actions that could reasonably benefit from having extra limbs, such as climbing and swimming.

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FLIGHT

Self • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

This Travel Power lets you fly like a bird, or a plane, or a cow with jet engines strapped onto its terrified back. You get the idea. Flight requires more room to maneuver than most Travel Powers, so you must halve your effective Flight rank indoors unless you are operating in an exceptionally large space.

PRO	**Spaceflight (+2):** You can move faster than light in outer space, allowing you to cross interstellar distances, assuming you can survive out there.
CON	**Gliding (–2):** You glide rather than fly, so you must descend at least one story (about 15 feet) per page unless you can catch a rising current of air.
CON	**Levitation (–4):** You can only move up and down or hover in place.
CON	**Slides (–2):** You surf on slides of matter or energy that you create as you travel, so you have to stay within Distant Range of the ground, buildings, or other large solid objects.
CON	**Wings (–2):** You need room to spread your wings, so you can't fly in cramped spaces (including most indoor locations), thin atmospheres, or the vacuum of space.

FORCE FIELD

Self • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can project a force field that repels damage. Characters protected by the force field can use your Power rank as a passive defense against both physical attacks and energy attacks, and are completely immune to such attacks if their attack rank is less than or equal to half your Force Field rank. When dealing with Minions, use their unmodified Threat rank as their attack rank when determining if protected characters are immune to their attacks. This Power blocks physical objects and energy attacks. It does not affect ambient energy that isn't intense enough to inflict harm (ordinary sounds, room temperate, visible light, etc.), nor does it block indirect Power effects. For example, someone with Darkness could affect the environment across a force field. This Power does not affect mental attacks in any way.

You can shape your force field however you wish, anything from a flat plane to a bubble that protects you and everyone adjacent to you. Apply the Zone Pro to shield large areas, the Ranged Pro to shield things at a distance, or the Area Pro to shield large areas at a distance. You must spend an action to activate this Power, but you can then maintain it as a free action. You can maintain multiple force fields at the same time, but this lowers your effective Power rank by 1d per extra force field.



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PRO **Inviolate (+1 per rank):** Whenever you raise a force field, you can spend 1 Resolve to have the field repel not only direct attacks, but also all Power effects of equal or lesser rank. An inviolate force field can even be used as a passive defense against mental attacks.

PRO **Permeable (+6):** If you wish, you can allow attacks to pass unhindered through the force field in one direction, letting you and your allies attack normally while protected by the field. An inviolate force field (as described above) can't also be permeable.

CON **Collapsible (–2):** Your force field collapses when struck by an attack whose rank exceeds your Power rank. Although the Power still acts as a passive defense against that attack, you will have to spend an action if you wish to reactivate your force field.

CON **Ward (–1):** Your Power protects against mental attacks and effects rather than physical ones. This is the only kind of force field that can hold a character using Phasing (Intangible).

FORM

This Power lets you turn yourself into something other than flesh and blood. The details vary depending on what you can turn yourself into.

ENERGY FORM

Self • Power Rank • 3 Hero Points per rank

You can turn into one type of energy (pick one), gaining Aura and Flight at this Power's rank. In this form, you are weightless and immune to physical and energy attacks and effects. While you can't carry or touch anything, you aren't truly intangible: objects and force fields can contain you. You also become vulnerable to things that can affect the energy that forms your body. For example, if you are composed of electricity, things that can absorb electricity may be able to harm you.

PRO **Also X (+2):** You can turn into one additional type of energy for every 2 extra Hero Points.

GASEOUS FORM

Self • Default Rank • 6 Hero Points

You can turn into a gas, gaining 1d Flight. In this form you are weightless and immune to physical attacks and effects (including energy attacks), and you can move through any opening through which gases can pass. You can't carry, touch, or affect anything physical while in this form, but you become vulnerable to things that can affect gases.

LIQUID FORM

Self • Default Rank • 12 Hero Points

You can turn into a liquid or a collection of fine particles like dust or sand, making you immune to physical attacks (but not energy attacks) and letting you pass through any opening liquids can pass through. You can nevertheless solidify yourself enough to manipulate objects and perform physical attacks. Although you are immune to physical attacks, your body is still a physical object that can be contained, moved, shoved, and otherwise affected by force fields and anything too large to pass through you.

SOLID FORM

Self • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can turn into solid matter (ice, metal, stone, and wood are always in fashion). While in this form, you can substitute your Power rank for your Might and Toughness, and you gain Armor at that rank as well. If you already have any of these Traits at an equal or greater rank, use their ranks +1d instead.

GESTALT

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You must have the Alter Ego Flaw to select this Power. Assuming you do, your empowered form is the product of two people merging. You have two separate alter egos, each of which is a separate character with their own unique Abilities, Talents, and maybe even Powers. You can have more than two alter egos, but each additional alter ego costs another 3 Hero Points.

GROWTH

Self • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can grow as large as shown on the **Growth** table. At rank 4d or higher, your weight rank equals your current Growth rank. You can substitute your current Growth rank for your Might and Toughness. You also gain Armor at your current Growth rank. Last, you gain Running at half your Growth rank thanks to the length of your stride. If you already have any of these Traits at an equal or greater rank, use their ranks +1d instead.

GROWTH

RANK	HEIGHT	RANK	HEIGHT
1d	7 feet	13d	75 feet
2d	8 feet	14d	100 feet
3d	9 feet	15d	125 feet
4d	10 feet	16d	150 feet
5d	12 feet	17d	200 feet
6d	15 feet	18d	250 feet
7d	20 feet	19d	300 feet
8d	25 feet	20d	400 feet
9d	30 feet	21d	500 feet
10d	40 feet	22d	600 feet
11d	50 feet	23d	800 feet
12d	60 feet	24d	1,000 feet

HARD TO KILL

Self • Default Rank • 1 Hero Point

You are hard to kill. You can be killed, but it would take something extreme, like being beheaded, dissolved in acid, or tossed into a volcano. Although Heroes can't die in standard P&P, characters with this power know they're hard to kill and can

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be roleplayed that way. When playing a game in which Heroes can die, GMs should charge more for this power (anywhere from 3 to 6 Hero Points).

HEALING

Touch • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can heal the injuries of anyone you touch. Your Power rank equals the maximum number of points of damage you can heal per day. The GM may also let this Power cure diseases with a successful Healing roll or perhaps by spending Resolve.

CON **Repair (–2):** Your touch repairs inanimate objects rather than heals living beings. It can heal damage inflicted on androids, cyborgs, machines, robots, vehicles, and most other technology.

HIBERNATION

Self • Default Rank • 1 Hero Point

You can enter a state of suspended animation and remain that way as long as you wish. You barely age and don't need to breathe, eat, or drink anything while hibernating. You remain fully aware of your surroundings in this state and can revive yourself anytime you wish.

HYPER BREATH

Special • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can inhale and exhale gale-force winds that can pull things toward you or push them away from you. This requires a successful Hyper Breath roll against the greater of each target's Might or weight rank. With 1 or 2 net successes, a target can be pulled to you or pushed out to Distant Range. With 3 or more net successes, the target also falls prone and loses their next turn to act. This power can either affect all targets within Close Range or a single target within Distant Range. You can also use Hyper Breath to disperse gasses or inhale and hold them as long as you can hold your breath, but this doesn't grant you any special immunity to caustic or toxic gasses.

PRO **Freezing (+1 per rank):** You can also use your breath to freeze targets, mimicking the effects of Blast (cold) or Ensnare, but only within Close Range.

ILLUSIONS

Zone • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can create illusions. Your illusions can be as small as you like, or they can fill the Power's area of effect with illusory sights and sounds. Your illusions exist in the real world and can be perceived by both living beings and inanimate objects like cameras and microphones. Observers will believe your illusions are real unless they have a reason to think otherwise, in which case they can make a Perception roll against your Power rank to see through them. Whether or not they believe them, anyone who attempts to touch your illusions will pass right through and immediately realize they aren't real. If you place an illusion over a physical object, however, merely touching it won't give anything away because the observer will touch the object underneath.

PRO **Mental (+2 per rank):** You create illusions in the minds of living beings. Observers who have a reason to believe your illusions aren't real use Willpower rather than Perception when trying to see through them. Although your illusions can't be detected by inanimate objects like cameras and microphones, they are more effective on living beings, who can be made to believe they have been blinded, bound, gagged, harmed, incapacitated, immobilized, or otherwise affected by some part of the illusion. Whatever the trappings, these illusory special effects all basically work like the Stun Power, but using your Illusions rank against the target's Willpower. Although your illusions can cover a large area, as described above, you can only target single individuals with illusory special effects like these unless you apply the Zone Pro.

IMMORTALITY

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You can't die or you don't stay dead. Maybe you always come back to life, maybe your consciousness gets transferred into a clone or duplicate body, etc. However it works, killing you doesn't stick. What's more, you won't grow old or die of old age, at least not within any time frame that matters. Although Heroes can't die in standard P&P, characters with this power know they can't die and can be roleplayed that way. When playing a game in which Heroes can die, GMs should charge more for this power (anywhere from 6 to 12 Hero Points).

CON **Vulnerable (–1):** You can be killed, but it's not an easy thing to do. Describe how.

IMMUNITY

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points per immunity

You are immune to certain attacks, conditions, effects, energies, hazards, or Powers. Select one or more of the following immunities or make up your own.

- **Attack X:** You are immune to a specific type of physical attack or weapon.
- **Energy X:** You are immune to a specific type of energy other than kinetic/physical energy.
- **Environmental:** You are immune to environmental hazards like pressure, radiation, and temperature.
- **Fatigue:** You never tire or get mentally fatigued and you don't need to rest or sleep.

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- **Life Support:** You don't need to breathe, eat, or drink, and you are immune to airborne toxins.
- **Mental States:** You are immune to negative emotions and mental states like fear and confusion.
- **Sensory:** You are immune to the Dazzle Power and similar sensory overload effects.
- **Toxins:** You are immune to diseases, drugs, and poisons.

INANIMATE

Self • Special • 9 Hero Points

You aren't alive, at least not in the usual sense. You might be a construct, a robot, undead, or something else. You are immune to physical attacks and Powers that only affect living beings, whether those Powers are harmful or helpful. Additionally, you effectively have Immunity (Life Support, Toxins). You still have a mind or spirit, so you remain vulnerable to mental attacks and Powers. This Power has no rank and can't be absorbed, drained, mimicked, or affected by other abilities. It does have a Source (other than Trained) which suggests what kind of being you are, as follows:

- **Innate:** you are a living being, but not in any way that resembles life on Earth.
- **Magic:** you are a supernatural being like an angel, devil, elemental, faery, golem, or undead.
- **Psychic:** you are an astral or ectoplasmic being like a ghost or spirit and are likely incorporeal.
- **Super:** you are inorganic matter or energy brought to life by some inexplicable phenomenon.
- **Tech:** you are an artificial construct like a clockwork being, nanoswarm, robot, or sentient program.

PRO **Mindless (+9):** You are also immune to mental attacks and Powers because you lack both mind and spirit, as in the case of a true robot or a magically animated skeleton or zombie.

INVISIBILITY

Self • Default Rank • 9 Hero Points

You can turn invisible. You can still be detected by other senses, by Powers like Attuned, Radar, and Super Senses, and by how you affect the environment (footprints in mud or snow, the movement of fog or rain, etc.). Enemies who can't see you suffer a –3d penalty to their attack rolls and active defense rolls against you unless they have a Power like Blind Fighting or Radar that compensates for this. Lower this penalty to –2d for enemies that can detect you as described above, even if they can't see you.

PRO **Cloaking (+3):** When you turn invisible, you also become undetectable to Radar and all Super Senses that involve vision. Additionally, you become undetectable to sensors and other equipment (magical, technological, or otherwise) that operates like these Powers.

CON **Jamming (–3):** You can't turn invisible, but you can render yourself undetectable to Radar and all Super Senses that involve vision. Additionally, you become undetectable to sensors and other equipment (magical, technological, or otherwise) that operates like these Powers.

IRRITANT

Zone • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can fill the area around you with an effect like a blinding sandstorm, hurricane force winds, noxious gas, or a swarm of insects. Everyone in the area other than you suffers a –2d penalty to all challenge rolls (other than passive defense rolls) unless their Toughness exceeds your Power rank. If you wish, you can specify that your version of the Power is resisted with Willpower instead of Toughness. You must use an action to activate this Power, but once you do, you can maintain it as a free action.

LANGUAGES

Self • Default Rank • 1 Hero Point

All characters can speak one or two languages, but you speak a number of extra languages equal to your Intellect. You can select these languages ahead of time or during play.

PRO **Hyper Translation (+2):** You are instantly fluent in any language you encounter. You can't speak languages your vocal cords can't mimic, or understand ones your senses can't perceive.

PRO **Polyglot (+1):** You have a natural talent for languages. You can master new languages in about a week or so and can normally learn enough to get by within a day or two.

LEADERSHIP

Self • Default Rank • 6 Hero Points

You lead your team in battle. As long as you can see and communicate with them, you can spend a free action to let each of your allies reroll one challenge roll per combat scene.

LEAPING

Self • Baseline Rank (½ Might) • 1 Hero Point per rank

This Travel Power lets you jump incredible distances, as shown on the **Leaping** table. Subtract 1d from your Power rank to determine how high you can jump straight up. Leaping can

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be used to travel long distances like any other Travel Power. This Power works best outdoors because it requires overhead clearance. As a result, your Leaping rank is capped at your Agility when making movement rolls indoors. Last, you can also use Leaping as an active defense against falling damage.

LEAPING

RANK	JUMP	RANK	JUMP
1d	5 feet	13d	10 miles
2d	10 feet	14d	25 miles
3d	25 feet	15d	50 miles
4d	50 feet	16d	100 miles
5d	100 feet	17d	250 miles
6d	250 feet	18d	500 miles
7d	500 feet	19d	1,000 miles
8d	1,000 feet	20d	2,500 miles
9d	2,500 feet	21d	5,000 miles
10d	1 mile	22d	Planetary
11d	2 miles	23d	Orbital
12d	5 miles	24d	Lunar

LIFE DRAIN

Touch • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can drain the life of any living being you touch by making a Life Drain roll against their Toughness or one of their active defenses. If you wish, you can specify that your version of the Power is resisted with Willpower instead of Toughness, but active defenses will always apply as well. You inflict 1 point of damage per net success rolled. If you are wounded, you also heal 1 point of damage for every 2 full points of damage inflicted. For example, you heal 1 point of damage whenever you inflict 2 or 3 points of damage. You don't have to be wounded to use this Power.

PRO **Vampirism (+1):** Rather than merely draining life energy, the Power inflicts actual physical damage so targets resist this Power like they would any ordinary attack that inflicts physical damage (using Armor, half their Toughness, or an active defense). Because the Power inflicts physical damage, it can be used to attack inanimate objects and beings. Nevertheless, you only heal damage when the Power is used on living targets.

LIGHT/EFFECT

Special • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You can generate light, normally visible light but you can generate ultraviolet light if you prefer. This is effortless and always considered a free action. Your light can fill the Zone around you, or you can focus it down to a beam or a harmless laser that extents to Distant Range. The light can be as bright as you like, but not so bright that it incapacitates others like Dazzle. That said, suddenly going from total darkness to bright light will probably stun just about anyone, if only for a moment. Although Light is the most common version of this ability, this Power can instead represent the ability to generate some other innocuous but useful environmental effect (in which case it's called Effect to avoid confusion).

LIGHTNING REFLEXES

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You have incredible reflexes. Increase your Edge by 6. Also, while this is mostly for narrative flair, you can draw, holster, or sheathe any weapon you carry in an instant. If using the Gritty Combat Rules in Chapter 4, this makes it impossible for anyone to get the drop on you.

CON **Fighting/Marksmanship (–1):** This Power only applies when performing close combat attacks or ranged combat attacks, respectively, and you can only quick draw those types of weapons.

LUCK

Self • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You are incredibly lucky or so skilled that you make everything look easy. You gain a number of Luck dice equal to your Luck rank at the start of every issue. Luck dice can be added to either side of any challenge roll that involves you. For example, you can spend 3 Luck dice to add +3d to one of your challenge rolls. You can also spend 3 Luck dice to oppose the roll of someone acting against you. In that case, you roll the dice, count your successes, and subtract them from the other person's roll. Much like when you spend Resolve, this happens automatically, without you needing to *do* anything.

PRO **Control (+4):** Rather than just being lucky, this Power represents your ability to consciously alter probability fields. This lets you use Luck on yourself and anyone you wish within Distant Range. Although you have to be conscious and aware, using this Power is considered a free action, and you can do so at any time — you don't have to wait for your turn to act.

PRO **Unbelievable (+1 per rank):** You can also spend Luck dice to buy yourself lucky breaks, as described in Chapter 5. Lucky breaks purchased with Luck dice are often more extreme, spectacular, and unlikely than those purchased with Resolve. Of course, they're still subject to the GM's approval and can't be used to break the game.

MACHINE CONTROL

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can control machines and electronic devices at up to Distant Range. For example, you can use this Power to hack into a computer, deactivate a security camera, or remotely control a car. You can also substitute your Power rank for whatever Trait you'd normally use to operate the machine or device. You can control multiple machines at the same time, but every extra

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machine controlled lowers your effective Power rank by 1d, and you still suffer the usual –2d penalty if you use the Power to perform multiple attacks or actions in combat.

CON **Interface (–2):** You can only control computers. However, this also lets you control any machine or device controlled by a computer, which covers a lot of ground.

MARTIAL ARTS

Touch • Baseline Rank (Might) • 1 Hero Point per rank

You are a master of unarmed combat. You can use this Power to perform and defend yourself against close combat attacks. You can also substitute your Martial Arts rank for your Might when performing and resisting grabs, holds, escapes, and combat stunts. You've also trained with weapons and can substitute your Martial Arts rank for your Ability ranks when using mundane melee weapons to attack or defend yourself (although the Gear Limit for mundane weapons still applies, as discussed in Chapter 6). Unlike most attack Powers, Martial Arts inflicts subdual damage (although you still inflict lethal damage when armed with a melee weapon that inflicts such damage).

PRO **Deflect (+4):** You can deflect ranged attacks. This lets you use Martial Arts as an active defense against ranged physical and energy attacks, but not against area attacks.

PRO **Deflect Missiles (+2):** You can deflect ranged attacks. This lets you use Martial Arts as an active defense against ranged physical attacks, but not against area attacks.

MASTER OF DISGUISE

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You are a master of disguise. You can create extremely realistic disguises in one short scene or less, assuming you have on hand whatever materials and supplies you need (and in a pinch, you can do wonders with ordinary household goods). You are also a master of mimicry, able to imitate the voice and mannerisms of others. Use Charm when making challenge rolls for this ability, typically opposed by your target's Perception. When the Item Con is applied to this Power, it must mean something more than just needing materials and supplies to craft your disguises because that is assumed.



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MATTER CHAMELEON

Self • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can take on the properties of objects you touch for the rest of the scene. This works like Solid Form, but your effective Power rank equals the lesser of your Matter Chameleon rank or the Structure of the object. You also take on the energetic properties of objects you touch, such as the heat of lava, gaining Aura at the lesser of your Matter Chameleon rank or the rank of the energy coming off the object. You suffer no damage from this unless the energy's rank exceeds your Power rank, and even then, this Power acts as a passive defense against energetic damage inflicted by touching objects.

MIND BLAST

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can fire a mental attack that targets the mind or spirit, inflicting psychic damage on living beings by making a Mind Blast roll against your target's Willpower. This Power has no effect on inanimate objects and in fact goes right through them unless they have a psychic presence.

MIND CONTROL

Ranged • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can make any living being within Distant Range do what you wish for the Power's duration by making a Mind Control roll against their Willpower. You can control your target immediately, or you can spend 1 Resolve to implant suggestions that will be triggered at some point in the future (possibly months or even years later, in which case the duration won't begin to run until the suggestion is triggered). Targets get a +2d bonus to resist commands that are totally against their natures or self-destructive.

CON **Hypnosis (–2):** You need to have a calm, face-to-face conversation with anyone whose mind you want to control, making this ability useless in combat.

CON **Pheromones (–2):** Your Power is chemical in nature. Characters use the greater of their Toughness or Willpower to resist it. Additionally, characters who don't breathe are immune to this Power, as are those protected by life support systems or immune to toxins.

NULLIFY

Zone • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can create a dampening field that nullifies the Abilities, Talents, and Powers of all characters within range, friend and foe alike. Nullified Abilities and Talents drop to 1d, while nullified Powers completely stop working. You can only nullify Traits if your Power rank equals or exceeds their rank, but this happens automatically: no roll is required. This Power only affects Traits from one Source (pick one). You have to concentrate to use this ability — you can only move at half speed, and you can't attack, use active defenses, or perform other actions while this Power is active unless you spend 1 point of Resolve to do so. A target affected by this Power may spend Resolve to muscle their way through and use a nullified Trait, but each page or use of a nullified Trait will cost them 1 point of Resolve.

PRO **Also X (Special):** You can affect Traits from more than one Source. Every additional Source increases this Power's cost by 1 Hero Point per rank. For example, this Power costs 4 Hero Points per rank if you can nullify Innate, Super, and Trained Traits.

OMNI-POWER

Special • Power Rank • 3 or 5 Hero Points per rank

You possess a versatile ability that lets you mimic other Powers at this Power's rank. You can mimic any number of Powers per page, and you can switch between them in an instant, but each use of this Power after the first on the same page lowers your effective Omni-Power rank by 1d for the rest of that page. For these purposes, a "use" is any action, movement, or challenge roll involving this Power.

Pandora is using her 12d Omni-Power to fly over the city (mimicking Flight). The demon she's hunting bursts out from the clouds above her, shrieking as it dives in her direction, so she blasts it with a bolt of arcane energy (mimicking Blast). This is the second use of Omni-Power on the same page, so Pandora rolls only 11d for her attack roll. She defeats the creature, but it wasn't alone. Two lesser fiends appear out of nowhere and attack Pandora on the same page. Pandora raises an arcane shield to protect herself (mimicking Armor). These are the third and fourth uses of Omni-Power on the same page, so Pandora rolls only 10d and 9d for her defense rolls against the two attacks.

This reduction concerns how often you use this Power in one page; it has nothing to do with how many actions you perform. Accordingly, if you use this Power to perform 2 or more attacks on the same page, you also suffer the usual multiple action penalty on your attack rolls (see Chapter 4).

Powers with a default rank can only be mimicked if your current Omni-Power rank equals or exceeds their cost in Hero Points. For example, you need at least 3d Omni-Power to mimic Light because that Power costs 3 Hero Points. Omni-Power cannot be used to mimic Alternate Form, Determination, Inanimate, Life Drain, Luck, Nullify, Power Absorption, Power Mimicry, Preparation, Slay, or Time Stop.

You can apply Pros to the Powers you mimic by spending 1 Resolve per Pro, or 2 Resolve for Pros that cost at least 4 Hero Points. If you spend Hero Points to apply a Pro to this Power overall, you can apply it to any Power you mimic without spending Resolve. Cons can only be applied to this Power overall,

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and affect all Powers you mimic. For example, if you apply the Signature Con to this Power, every Power you mimic will have the Signature Con.

There are two types of Omni-Powers: narrow and broad. Narrow Omni-Powers can imitate a limited set of abilities, and cost 3 Hero Points per rank. Broad Omni-Powers can imitate a wide array of abilities, and cost 5 Hero Points per rank. You must describe what your Omni-Power does when you select it so that both you and your GM understand what it can and can't do. This is especially important for broad Omni-Powers, which often do many things but should never let you do everything. Use the examples below as a guide. GMs are free to limit or prohibit this Power.

- **Arsenal (narrow):** You carry a collection of arrows, boomerangs, bullets, grenades, shuriken, etc., that let you imitate Powers that inflict damage and special effects.
- **Gadgets (broad):** You carry an assortment of technological wonders that you can use to imitate the effects of a wide variety of Powers.
- **Gizmos (narrow):** You wear a utility belt or pack, or perhaps you have items built into your body. This lets you imitate Powers that represent a wide variety of mundane tools and miscellaneous equipment.
- **Quantum Control (broad):** You can control matter and energy at the quantum level, and probably have some control over time and space as well.
- **Sensors (narrow):** Common among high-tech characters, you have an advanced sensor suite that can imitate the effects of most Super Senses involving hearing or vision.
- **Sorcery (broad):** You are a practitioner of the arcane arts who uses your vast magical knowledge to create an assortment of magical effects that are somehow related.

PHASING

Self • Default Rank • 9 Hero Points

You can shift your body out of phase with the physical world. This makes you immune to physical attacks and effects (including energy attacks), but not to mental ones. It also allows you to pass through solid objects, but not through force fields. You can't carry, touch, or affect anything physical while phased. Activating or deactivating this Power is a free action, but you cannot do both on the same turn to act (use Blink to represent the ability to quickly activate and deactivate this Power in combat).

PRO **Intangible (+3):** Normal force fields can't hold you, but those with the Ward Con can, unless your Willpower exceeds their Power rank.

PLASTICITY

Self • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

Your body is rubbery and elastic, allowing you to mold yourself into different shapes and squeeze through the tightest openings. You can create different effects at your Plasticity rank by shaping yourself into different forms. For example, you can imitate Leaping by shaping yourself into a ball, you can use Plasticity instead of Might to hold something in place by winding or wrapping yourself around it, or you can use yourself as a parachute for anything with a weight rank less than or equal to your Power rank. In combat, you can use Plasticity as a passive defense against physical attacks, but not against energy attacks, and you can substitute Plasticity for Might when grappling or performing close combat attacks. If your Might exceeds your Power rank, use Might +1d instead.

POLYMORPH

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can turn living beings into some harmless or helpless form (a frog, a sheep, a statue, whatever) by making a Polymorph roll against their Toughness or one of their active defenses. If you wish, you can specify that your version of the Power is resisted with Willpower instead of Toughness, but active defenses will always apply as well. The target transforms for the Power's duration. Some Villains and Foes may have versions of this Power that last much longer, even permanently!

PORTABLE STOREHOUSE

Self • Default Rank • 6 Hero Points

You can access a storehouse of mundane weapons, armor, gear, and even vehicles from wherever you are. This might involve teleporting these things to and from a secret warehouse, pulling them out of a magic bag or hat, carrying them around in shrunken form, creating them out of thin air, or something else entirely. These items only last until the end of the scene, unless you have Resources or Wealth, in which case you may very well be using this Power to grab your own items out of storage.

POSSESSION

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can possess the body of living beings within Distant Range by making a Possession roll against your target's Willpower. While possessing someone, you use their physical Abilities, Talents, and Powers and your mental Abilities, Talents, and Powers (it's the GM's call). While you are using this Power, your physical body lies dormant, but you will instantly know if it gets moved or harmed. You automatically jump back to your own body if the person you are possessing gets knocked out or killed.

PRO **Meld (+4):** Your body melds into that of anyone you possess for the power's duration.

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POWER ABSORPTION

Touch • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can steal a character's Abilities, Talents, and Powers from a specific Source (pick one) by making a Power Absorption roll against their highest-ranked Trait that shares this Source or one of their active defenses. If successful, your target falls unconscious and you gain the stolen Traits at their rank for the Power's duration. If you already have a stolen Trait at an equal or greater rank, your Trait is unaffected. You can possess the Traits of multiple characters at the same time, but this lowers your effective Power rank by 1d per extra character. If used on a Minion whose abilities come from the correct Source (it's the GM's call), you gain an attack and defense rank equal to their Threat if that's better than what you would normally use. This Power requires physical contact, so it can't affect anyone completely hidden behind artificial armor or a force field.

PRO **Also X (Special):** You can absorb Traits from more than one Source. Every additional Source increases this Power's cost by 1 Hero Point per rank. For example, this Power costs 4 Hero Points per rank if you can absorb Innate, Super, and Trained Traits.

CON **Only X (–2 or –4):** You can only absorb one type of Trait. This is usually a –2 Con and means you can only affect Abilities, Talents, or Powers (pick one). If you can only absorb one specific Ability, Talent, or Power (again, pick one), this is a –4 Con instead.

POWER MIMICRY

Touch • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can mimic a character's Abilities, Talents, and Powers from a specific Source (pick one) by making a Power Mimicry roll against their highest-ranked Trait that shares this Source or one of their active defenses. If successful, you gain the mimicked Traits at their rank for the Power's duration. If you already have a mimicked Trait at an equal or greater rank, your Trait is unaffected. This does not affect your target in any way. You can possess the Traits of multiple characters at the same time, but this lowers your effective Power rank by 1d per extra character. If used on a Minion whose abilities come from the correct Source (it's the GM's call), you gain an attack and defense rank equal to their Threat if that's better than what you would normally use. This Power requires physical contact, so it can't affect anyone completely hidden behind artificial armor or a force field.

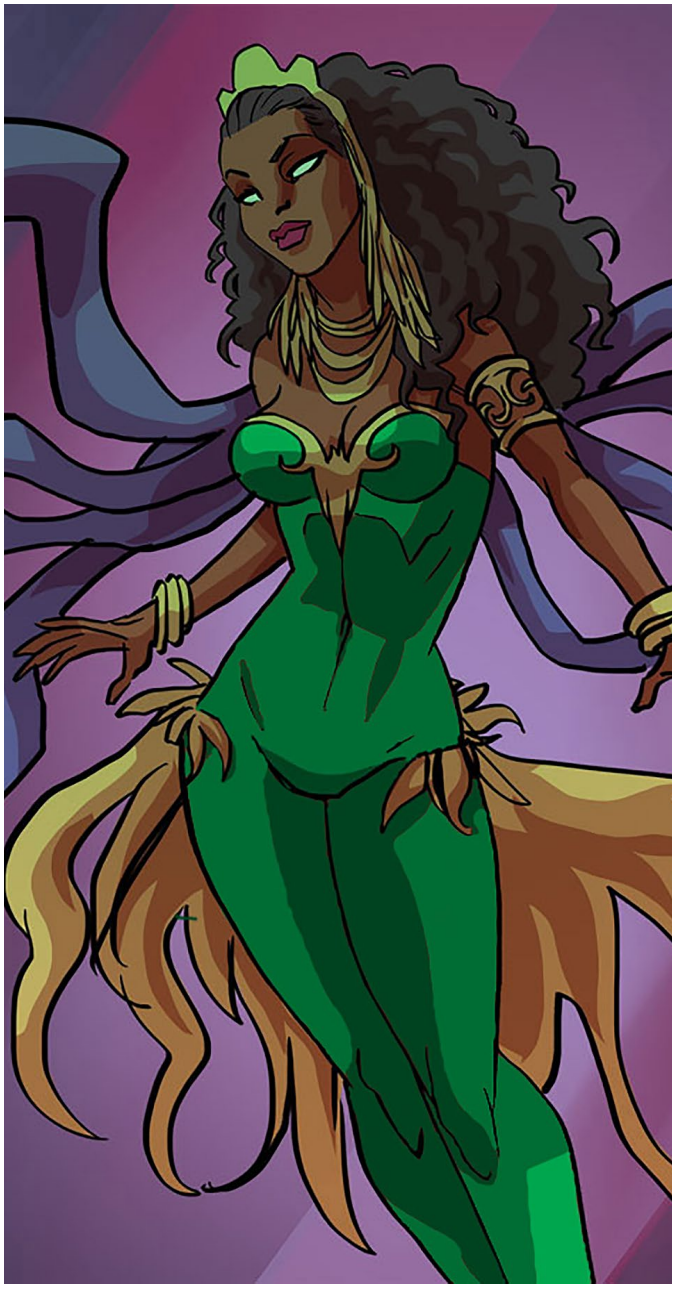
PRO **Also X (Special):** You can mimic Traits from more than one Source. Every additional Source increases this Power's cost by 1 Hero Point per rank. For example, this Power costs 4 Hero Points per rank if you can mimic Innate, Super, and Trained Traits.

CON **Only X (–2 or –4):** You can only absorb one type of Trait. This is usually a –2 Con and means you can only affect Abilities, Talents, or Powers (pick one). If you can only absorb one specific Ability, Talent, or Power (again, pick one), this is a –4 Con instead.

PRECOGNITION

Self • Default Rank • 12 Hero Points

You can rewrite events that have already happened, perhaps because you can see into the future, predict the most likely outcome of any course of action, or actually turn back time. However this works, you can spend Resolve to negate something that just happened in the game. In combat, this erases a character's turn and lets you skip your normal place in the action sequence and immediately take your next turn to act before they repeat theirs. You must declare this as soon as a character finishes their turn to act, if not sooner. Once another character begins to act, you can't go back any farther than the start of the acting character's turn. This costs 1 Resolve the first time you use this Power in a scene, 2 Resolve the second time, 3 Resolve the third time, and so on. Characters are not refunded Resolve or Adversity spent during an erased turn. GMs should feel free to disallow this Power.



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PREPARATION

Self • Special • 6 Hero Points

Thanks to your penchant for meticulous research and planning, you tend to be prepared for any situation. As discussed in Chapter 5, all Heroes can spend 1 Resolve to make up some minor detail about the game world, often a lucky break that works in their favor. This Power lets you take that one step further, making these narrations much more effective if they can be explained by your research and planning. This allows you to declare that you are carrying the perfect item, tool, or mundane weapon (assuming your gear hasn't been taken from you), that you planted something in or otherwise prepared your current location ahead of time, that you already know or have access to information you need, or that you know or have pull with some Extra. Preparation isn't an instant win button you can use to narrate your way around every challenge or obstacle the GM throws your way. Even with this Power, the GM can veto any narration they consider unreasonable or game-breaking. This Power has no rank and can't be absorbed, drained, mimicked, or affected by other abilities.

Vigilant has this Power. While chasing the crystalline supervillain Shard through the city's sewer system, Vigilant spends 1 Resolve to say that he memorized the layout of the city's sewers long ago. Knowing this, he manages to get ahead of Shard, who rounds a bend to find the city's dark protector waiting for him. Massively strong and impervious to most weapons, Shard isn't impressed. After all, Vigilant's just a guy in a costume. Shard charges at him, expecting to pound him into jelly. Our hero spends 1 more Resolve to declare that he's done his research on Shard and knows all there is to know about him. Since Shard's been in and out of jail a few times, the GM agrees, and she discloses that Shard is vulnerable to sonic and vibratory attacks. Vigilant spends 1 final point of Resolve to declare that, having discovered this, he temporarily added vibrating knuckles to his costume's armored gauntlets. For the duration of this scene, his unarmed attacks will inflict vibratory damage. One well-placed uppercut later and Shard is on his back, knocked unconscious by just a guy in a costume.

PSI-SCREEN

Self • Baseline Rank (Willpower) • 1 Hero Point per rank

You've honed your mental and spiritual defenses. Use Psi-Screen instead of Willpower when defending yourself against mental attacks and resisting mental damage and effects. Also, you know when someone tries to use Telepathy to read your surface thoughts, and you can use this Power to resist such attempts. You can also use this Power to resist attempts to probe your mind.

PRO **Cloak Mind (+2):** You can hide your mental presence from telepaths. Anyone who wants to use Telepathy to detect you must make a successful Telepathy roll against your Psi-Screen rank.

PSYCHOMETRY

Touch • Default Rank • 9 Hero Points

You can pick up psychic impressions and glean information from physical objects. You can ask the GM about the basic history of any inanimate object you touch. If you spend 1 Resolve, you can ask for in-depth information about a specific person or event connected to the object, assuming there's any information to be had. The information received may sometimes be incomplete or misleading, but it is always truthful and must address the subject of your question.

QUICK CHANGE

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You can change your attire and/or grooming (hairstyle, makeup, etc.) in an instant. Describe how this works. Using this Power takes an action.

CON **Costume (–1):** You can only change into your costume or into what you were wearing (if anything) when you last changed into your costume.

RADAR

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You have some kind of radar sense that provides a three-dimensional image of your surroundings. This doesn't let you see flat images like print, pictures, or video displays.

CON **Sonar (–1):** This Power only works underwater.

CON **Tremor Sense (–1):** Rather than using radar, you are sensitive to vibrations in the ground. You can only detect beings and objects that are in contact with the ground or causing the ground to vibrate, as might be the case with low-flying helicopters or VTOL jets.

REGENERATION

Self • Default Rank • 6 Hero Points

You recover from injuries very quickly: you heal 1 point of damage per hour. If you get knocked unconscious, you awaken as soon as you heal 1 point of damage (if not revived sooner).

PRO **Fast (+6):** You heal 1 point of damage per minute instead of per hour.

PRO **Instant (+18):** You heal 1 point of damage per page instead of per hour.

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RESISTANCE

Self • Baseline Rank (Toughness) • 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks

You are resistant to radiation, temperature extremes, and toxins (diseases, drugs, and poisons). Use this Power instead of Toughness when rolling to resist hazards like these.

RUNNING

Self • Baseline Rank (3d) • 1 Hero Point per rank

This Travel Power lets you run faster than normal. This can also represent rolling on wheels, skating, or even bouncing like a ball. This Power's 3d baseline rank reflects standard human running speed.

PRO **Hover (+2):** You hover up to 1 foot above the ground when using this Power. This allows you to ignore caltrops, pressure plates, squeaky floors, tripwires, uneven ground, and so on.

SEPARATION

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You can detach your body parts without the usual side effects like screaming and bleeding to death. Your detached parts act independently and can generally do whatever a detached but otherwise healthy body part might reasonably be able to do, taking your other Powers into account. For example, a detached hand can crawl around on the ground, manipulate objects, and scare the hell out of people. If you can fly, then your hand probably can too.

SHOCKWAVE

Zone • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks

You can generate a concussive wave that targets everyone within range, friend and foe alike. This requires a successful Shockwave roll against the greater of each target's Might or weight rank. With 1 or 2 net successes, a target is pushed away from you and suffers a –1d penalty to all challenge rolls until after your next turn to act. The target remains within Close Range of you, but they're no longer adjacent to you if they were beforehand. With 3 or more net successes, the target is also knocked prone and loses their next turn to act. This Power shatters fragile materials like ordinary glass and ice in its area of effect.

SHRINKING

Self • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can shrink, becoming as small as shown on the **Shrinking** table and lowering your weight rank by your current Shrinking rank until it reaches 0d. You can substitute your current Shrinking rank for your Agility. You also gain Leaping and Strike at half your current Shrinking rank. If you already have any of these Traits at an equal or greater rank, use their ranks +1d instead. As discussed in Chapter 4, your size may also make it easier to hit others and avoid the attacks of human-sized enemies.

SHRINKING

RANK	HEIGHT	RANK	HEIGHT
1d to 2d	3 feet	13d to 14d	½ inch
3d to 4d	2 feet	15d to 16d	¼ inch
5d to 6d	1 foot	17d to 18d	⅛ inch
7d to 8d	6 inches	19d to 20d	Flea-sized
9d to 10d	3 inches	21d to 22d	Mite-sized
11d to 12d	1 inch	23d to 24d	Microscopic

SLAY

Touch • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can harm living targets you touch by making a Slay roll against their Toughness or one of their active defenses. If you wish, you can specify that your version of the Power is resisted with Willpower instead of Toughness, but active defenses will always apply as well. You inflict 2 points of damage per net success rolled. Armor has no effect on this Power.

SLICK

Zone • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can make all or any portion of the ground within range slippery for the rest of the scene or until you dispel this effect. Anyone attempting to cross the slick must make an Agility roll against your Power rank to avoid falling. Characters who fail this roll fall prone. Attempting to stand requires an action and another Agility roll against your Power rank. Until they make this roll, characters caught in the slick can't leave the area, at least not on foot, and suffer a –2d penalty to their attack rolls and active defense rolls. A character driving a ground vehicle over the slick must make a Vehicles roll against your Power rank to keep from sliding out of control and crashing into something.

SPEAK WITH DEAD

Self • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can momentarily animate the bodies of the dead to speak with them. This lets you ask the deceased your Power rank number of questions which must be answered truthfully. The dead will know only what they did while they were alive and can only communicate in a language they knew. As you might imagine, you need a dead body (or at least a head) to use this Power.

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SPECIALTY

Self • Special • 0 Hero Points

This Power is only available in Street Level and Low Level games, typically ones involving Heroes who lack true superpowers and share similar backgrounds, characteristics, and/or training. It provides niche protection that helps differentiate characters who might otherwise be too similar, such as a group of adolescent mutant ninja critters or a paramilitary group of True American Heroes. This Power allows each Hero to excel at something unique to them. The basic combat and non-combat Specialties are described below, but you are encouraged to create your own. This Power has no rank and can't be absorbed, drained, mimicked, or affected by other abilities.

When playing a game using Specialties, each Hero selects one Specialty for free (notice that this Power costs 0 Hero Points). No Hero can have more than one Specialty, and each Hero must have their own. In some games, GMs may let Heroes select two Specialties, one combat Specialty and one non-combat Specialty (again, no two Heroes can have the same Specialty). Your Specialty does two things. First, you get a +1d bonus to certain types of challenge rolls, even if this bonus effectively pushes you over the game's Trait Cap. Second, when making these rolls, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode. That means you get to roll those dice again to try generating extra successes, and you get to keep rerolling them as long as you keep rolling 6s.

COMBAT SPECIALTIES

- **Acrobat:** You get a +1d bonus to movement rolls and active defense rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Blaster:** You get a +1d bonus to ranged attack rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Grappler:** You get a +1d bonus to grappling rolls of any kind. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Striker:** You get a +1d bonus to close combat attack rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Support:** You get a +1d bonus to rolls made to perform combat stunts (see Chapter4). Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Tank:** You get a +1d bonus to Toughness rolls, Willpower rolls, and passive defense rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.

NON-COMBAT SPECIALTIES

- **Detective:** You get a +1d bonus to Investigation rolls and Streetwise rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Driver/Pilot:** You get a +1d bonus to Charm rolls and Vehicles rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Executive:** You get a +1d bonus to Command rolls and Professional rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Explorer:** You get a +1d bonus to Academics rolls and Survival rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Face:** You get a +1d bonus to Charm rolls and Professional rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Infiltrator:** You get a +1d bonus to Covert rolls and Investigation rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Journalist:** You get a +1d bonus to Charm rolls and Investigation rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Mechanic:** You get a +1d bonus to Technology rolls and Vehicles rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Medic:** You get a +1d bonus to Medicine rolls and Science rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Scholar:** You get a +1d bonus to Academics rolls and Investigation rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Scientist:** You get a +1d bonus to Investigation rolls and Science rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Scout:** You get a +1d bonus to Covert rolls and Survival rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Soldier:** You get a +1d bonus to Command rolls and Survival rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Techie:** You get a +1d bonus to Science rolls and Technology rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.
- **Thief:** You get a +1d bonus to Covert rolls and Streetwise rolls. Additionally, you can spend 1 Resolve to have your 6s explode when making these rolls.

SPINNING

Self • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can spin along your axis at superhuman speed. This lets you use Spinning in place of Might when performing and defending yourself against close combat attacks, grabs, holds, escapes, and combat stunts. You can also use Spinning in place of Agility

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when defending yourself against physical attacks, but not against energy attacks. If your Abilities are of equal or greater rank, use their rank +1d instead. You can move, speak, and interact with others normally while spinning.

STAR GATE

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You can instantly transport yourself to distant worlds. Although it involves travel, you must spend an action to use this Power. The first time you travel to an unfamiliar world, you arrive at a random location determined by the GM. After that, you return to where you were when you left, or you can spend 1 Resolve to arrive at another familiar location of your choosing. You can use this Power a number of times per issue equal to your Willpower without paying anything. Each use after that costs 1 Resolve.

PRO **Portal (+2):** You can create portals through which others (including ships) can travel.

STRETCHING

Self • Default Rank • 1, 3 or 6 Hero Points

You can stretch, telescope, or extend your body, or maybe you have long reach. You can perform close combat attacks and grappling attacks against targets that aren't adjacent to you. The 1-point version of this Power lets you reach targets within Close Range. The 3-point version lets you reach targets within Distant Range. The 6-point version lets you reach targets within Extreme Range. Out of combat, these distances indicate about how far you can reach or stretch yourself.

CON **Long Reach (–1):** You have long reach but can't stretch your whole body.

STRIKE

Touch • Baseline Rank (Might) or (Martial Arts) • 1 Hero Point per rank

You have some kind of damaging close combat attack like claws, energized fists, or a unique melee weapon. You can use this Power to both perform and defend yourself against close combat attacks. You must specify the kind of damage inflicted when you buy this Power (unless you apply the Weapons Con (discussed below). Occasionally, a more descriptive term may be used when the Power inflicts physical damage. For example, Strike (Bite) or Strike (Claws) may be used in place of Strike (Physical). This is purely for flavor and has no mechanical effect.

PRO **Deflect (+4):** You can deflect ranged attacks. This lets you use Strike as an active defense against ranged physical and energy attacks, but not against area attacks.



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PRO **Deflect Missiles (+2):** You can deflect ranged attacks. This lets you use Strike as an active defense against ranged physical attacks, but not against area attacks.

PRO **Reach/Throw (+2):** The Power can be used against opponents who aren't adjacent to you, as long as they're within Close Range. Either the Power has unusually long reach (Reach) or you can somehow throw whatever you use to attack enemies in close combat (Throw).

PRO **Sweep (+4):** The Power can be used as an area attack that targets all characters in a 90-degree arc within 5 to 25 feet of you. Like all area attacks, this targets both friend and foe within the area of effect. If the Power also has Reach, you can affect targets up to 50 feet away. You decide how far the attack reaches each time you use this Pro.

CON **Subdual (–1):** This Power inflicts subdual damage.

CON **Weapons (–1):** This Power represents mastery of a group of weapons as broad or narrow as you like — the level of specificity doesn't matter. You must be armed with that type of weapon to use the Power. This lets you use your Strike rank (instead of your Ability plus Weapon Bonus) to make attack rolls and defense rolls against close combat attacks while so armed. Otherwise, the weapon works as usual and deals whatever type of damage it normally inflicts.

STUN

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can incapacitate a living opponent by disabling them, stunning them, paralyzing them, putting them to sleep, or doing anything else that takes them out of the action by making a Stun roll against their Toughness or one of their active defenses. If you wish, you can specify that your version of the Power is resisted with Willpower instead of Toughness, but active defenses always apply as well.

CON **EMP (–2):** The Power affects characters with the Inanimate Power from a Tech Source instead of living beings. It can also disable most devices with electronic components.

SUMMONING

Self • Power Rank • Special

You can animate, call, or summon Minions to do your bidding. Your Power rank determines how many Minions you can summon per scene, as shown on the **Summoning** table. You determine your Minions' Threat rank when you purchase this Power. You can select any rank up to the game's Trait Cap - 6d, unless you can summon no more than 10 Minions per scene, in which case you can select any rank up to the game's Trait Cap - 3d. This Power costs 1 Hero Point per rank for every 2d Threat you give your Minions (round up as always). For example, if your Minions have 5d or 6d Threat, this Power costs 3 Hero Points per rank. Summoned Minions are close combat fighters unless you apply the Shooters Pro (see below). Summoning Minions is an action, but your Minions can act on the page in which they appear.

SUMMONING

RANK	MINIONS
1d to 2d	2
3d to 5d	5
6d to 8d	10
9d to 11d	25
12d to 14d	50
15d to 17d	100
18d to 20d	250
21d to 23d	500
24d to 26d	1,000

PRO **Animals (+1 or +2 per rank):** Your Minions are animals, so they possess special abilities like enhanced senses and the ability to move faster than ordinary human beings. Work with your GM to make up the specifics depending on the kind of animals you can summon. This Pro costs +1 per rank if you can summon a narrow selection of animals or +2 per rank if you can summon a wide variety of animals with different special abilities.

PRO **Automatons (+1 per rank):** Your Minions have the Inanimate (Mindless) Power.

PRO **Duplicates (+2 per rank):** Your Minions are duplicates of you. Although they work like ordinary Minions and use their Threat for all attacks, defenses, and other challenge rolls, your duplicates share your unique abilities and can do things other Minions can't. For example, if you can fly, phase through walls, or shoot energy beams out of your eyes, your duplicates can do so as well. Having a large number of duplicates can have significant narrative benefits (shortening the time of a long project considerably; searching an entire building in moments; highly efficient disaster relief; etc.) so discuss expectations with your GM before selecting this Pro.

PRO **Shooters (+1 per rank):** Your Minions can also attack enemies within Distant Range.

PRO **Unique (+1 to +4 per rank):** Your Minions have unique abilities that would be represented by Powers if they weren't Minions, things like acute senses, flight, or the ability to walk through walls. Work with your GM to describe what your Minions can do. This Pro costs +1 per rank if it gives your Minions a minor advantage, +2 per rank if it gives them a moderate advantage, or +4 per rank if it gives them a major advantage. This Pro is subject to the GM's approval.

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SUPER SENSES

Your senses are enhanced in some way. Select all the following that apply. Regardless of the options you select, Super Senses is always considered a single Power with an effective rank equal to your Perception or your Acute X rank, whichever is greater.

ACUTE X

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks

One of your senses is hyper acute (pick one). Substitute your Acute X rank for you Perception when making challenge rolls involving that sense (but not when determining your Edge).

ANALYTIC X

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 1 Hero Point

You can use one of your senses (pick one) to determine the basic physical properties of anything you concentrate on, including chemical composition and whether something is organic or inorganic.

ASTRAL SIGHT

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 1 Hero Point

You can see into the astral realm, the realm of psychic energy tied to the physical world. Among other things, this lets you interact with invisible spirits and characters using Astral Projection. It also lets you detect camouflaged living beings who are using Powers like Blending or Invisibility.

CIRCULAR VISION

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 1 Hero Point

You effectively have a 360-degree field of view.

ENHANCED HEARING

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 1 Hero Point

You can detect extremely faint, distant, or muffled sounds impossible for ordinary humans to hear by making a Perception roll at a threshold of 4 or higher, as determined by the GM depending on the circumstances. Additionally, you can hear infrasound and ultrasound.

HYPERSENSITIVE TOUCH

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 1 Hero Point

Your sense of touch is sensitive enough to read print with your fingertips or discern what's happening in an adjacent room by feeling the vibrations through a door or wall.

LIE DETECTION

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 3 Hero Points

You can detect when someone within Close Range is lying. You might need to make a Perception roll if the person is somehow protected from this Power, but otherwise this is automatic.

MICROSCOPIC VISION

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 1 Hero Point

If you concentrate, you can see microscopic details, maybe even down to the atomic, subatomic, or quantum level. In short, you can achieve whatever level of magnification the story requires.

NIGHT VISION

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 3 Hero Points

Through whatever means, you can see in absolute darkness.

RADIO HEARING

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 1 Hero Point

You can hear radio frequencies and intercept radio transmissions.

TELESCOPIC VISION

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 1 Hero Point

You can make out small details at extremely long distances. As with Microscopic Vision, you can basically see as far as you need to for purposes of the story.

THERMAL VISION

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 2 Hero Points

You can see heat patterns, allowing you to see through thin objects and follow even the faintest traces of residual thermal energy. This also lets you see in the dark, but it can be foiled by things like extreme ambient temperatures and beings whose body temperatures match their surroundings precisely.

TRACKING SCENT

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 1 Hero Point

You can identify, recognize, track others, and even determine their emotional state by scent. These feats require Perception rolls at a threshold of 4 to 6 under optimal conditions.

TRUE SIGHT

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 6 Hero Points

If you concentrate, you can see a being's true form, penetrating disguises, illusions, and transformations of any kind, including Powers like Blending and Invisibility. You might need to make a Perception roll if the person is somehow shielded from this effect, but otherwise this is automatic.

ULTRA VISION

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 2 Hero Points

You can see in ultraviolet light, which is normally invisible to the human eye. You also have low-light vision, allowing you to see in lighting as dim as starlight, but not in absolute darkness.

X-RAY VISION

Self • Baseline Rank (Perception) • 6 Hero Points

If you concentrate, you can see through solid objects.

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SUPER SPEED

Self • Power Rank • 3 Hero Points per rank

You move at superhuman speed. This works like any other Travel Power and then some. You can run at Power rank speed, your Agility effectively equals your Super Speed rank, and your Edge equals your Super Speed rank times 3. You can use this Power to perform and defend yourself against close combat attacks. You can also substitute Super Speed for Might when defending yourself in grappling combat. If you have Super Speed at 9d or greater, you gain a number of benefits: you can cross 2 range classes per page in combat, you can run across water and up walls, you defeat 2 Minions per net success when targeting them in close combat, and you effectively gain the Quick Change and Vanish Powers. You can compare your speed to the 10 mile-per-hour speed of an ordinary person to gauge how fast you really are and how quickly you can perform mundane tasks. For example, 9d Super Speed lets you run 1,000 miles per hour, making you roughly 100 times faster than an ordinary human being.



SWIMMING

Self • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks

This Travel Power lets you move through water at great speeds. Additionally, you can breathe water, you move as freely underwater as you do through air, your senses are not impaired underwater, and you are immune to oceanic pressure and temperature.

CON **Lungs (–1):** You can't breathe water, but you can hold your breath for a long time.

SWING LINE

Self • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks

This Travel Power allows you to ascend, descend, and swing from place to place. It only works outdoors or in large indoor areas with enough overhead space for you to swing around. You must remain within Distant Range of buildings, tall trees, or other stable objects to which you can tether your swing lines. Your lines have a Structure equal to half your Power rank. If you have Swing Line at 7d or greater, something more than simple gravity is propelling you from place to place.

CON **Natural (–2):** You can't create your own swing lines, so this Power only works in jungles and other environments that provide you with natural lines such as vines.

TELEKINESIS

Ranged • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can move objects at up to Distant Range with your mind. Use your Telekinesis rank as your effective Might when doing so. You can use this Power to attack, immobilize, lift, and toss beings and objects around. Telekinesis can also be used as an active defense against ranged attacks. Ranged physical attacks can be affected directly, but ranged energy attacks have to be blocked with physical objects — use the lesser of your Telekinesis rank or the Structure of the shielding object (or the Body of the shielding vehicle) when using this Power to defend yourself against energy attacks. You can control multiple objects at one time, but this lowers your effective rank by 1d per extra object controlled, and you still suffer the usual multiple action penalties if you perform more than one action per page.

CON **Impel (–4):** You can move objects in a straight line or hold them in place, but fine manipulation and subtle control is beyond you.

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TELEPATHY

Ranged • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can read minds and transmit your thoughts to anyone within Distant Range. You can sense sentient minds within range, but other telepaths can cloak their mental presence if they wish. You must make an opposed Telepathy roll against a cloaked telepath to sense them. You can also read a person's surface thoughts by making a Telepathy roll against the higher of their Willpower or Telepathy rank, although telepaths can sense this. Last, you can probe a person's memories for specific information by making a Telepathy roll against the higher of their Willpower or Telepathy rank. This takes a few minutes of absolute concentration, and even non-telepaths can feel when someone is digging through their memories. A successful mind probe reveals regular memories, repressed memories, and even original memories that have been altered in some way and can be restored if desired.

PRO **Alter Memories (+6):** Whenever you roll 3 or more net successes while performing a mind probe, you can alter a subject's memories however you wish. These alterations are temporary, lasting the rest of the scene, but if you spend 1 Resolve, you can make them permanent.

PRO **Cloak Others (+2):** You can cloak the mental presence of everyone within Close Range of you, making their minds undetectable to this Power (as described above).

PRO **Dream Travel (+2):** You can enter, observe, and participate in the dreams of others. While in a dream, your physical Traits are replaced by the greater of your Willpower or Telepathy rank.

PRO **Mind Link (+2):** You can link a number of minds equal to your Power rank so that everyone can telepathically communicate with everyone else. Linked characters must remain within Extreme Range of you to access the mind link.

CON **Empathy (–2):** Your telepathic abilities are limited to sensing, reading, and transmitting emotions and mental states, but stop short of concrete things like words and images.

SUPER TIP!

Time Stop and Time Travel can be excellent in certain players' hands and absolutely game-breaking in others. We include them for the sake of being complete, but urge GMs to think carefully before letting Heroes have either ability.

TELEPORTATION

Self • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

You can instantly travel as far as shown on the **Teleportation** table. You can teleport through solid objects, but not through force fields. You have no trouble reaching places you can see or locations whose layout you know well. If you try teleporting to an unfamiliar place, roll two dice. A result of 6 or less means you almost teleport into a solid object, so the Power fails. When that happens, you reappear in your original location and the shock knocks you unconscious for the rest of the scene (you can spend 1 Resolve to remain conscious). Each use of this Power is a move, no matter how far you travel. However, you can spend 1 Resolve to teleport twice in one page, provided you use 1 action and the total distance covered doesn't exceed the maximum distance you can teleport.

TELEPORTATION

RANK	DISTANCE
1d to 2d	50 feet
3d to 5d	500 feet
6d to 8d	1 mile
9d to 11d	10 miles
12d to 14d	100 miles
15d to 17d	1,000 miles
18d to 20d	Planetary
21d to 23d	Orbital
24d to 26d	Lunar

PRO **Portal (+2):** You can create portals through which others can travel.

CON **Medium (–2):** You can only teleport along or through a medium such as along power lines, through shadows, or into and out of reflective surfaces.

TIME STOP

Zone • Power Rank • 3 Hero Points per rank

You can stop the flow of time in the Power's area of effect for a number of pages equal to your Power rank or until you dispel this effect. This costs 1 Resolve the first time you use this Power in a scene, 2 Resolve the second time, 3 Resolve the third time, and so on. While this Power is active, everyone and everything in the area is frozen, stuck in time. You can move around freely while this Power is in effect, and you can move objects and people around (assuming you are strong enough to do so), but you can't otherwise affect or harm anything stuck in time. Although energy and forces affect you while this Power is active, they don't affect anyone or anything else. For example, you can't defy gravity or walk across lava while this Power is active, but you can place an object in mid-air or in a fire, and the object will sit there, hovering in the air or untouched by the flames, until time begins moving again. You can also do something like place a live grenade at someone's feet and then dispel the Power. This is another Power GMs should feel free to disallow if they don't want to deal with the potential for abuse.

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TIME TRAVEL

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You can travel through time, forward or backward, as far as you like. Although it involves travel, you must spend an action to use this Power. Time Travel can be a major headache, so discuss this Power with your GM ahead of time. If the GM approves, they'll have to determine how time travel works, including the age-old question of whether you can change the present by altering the past (we highly recommend Kevin Kulp's amazing *TimeWatch* roleplaying game published by Pelgrane Press for some great ideas on all things time travel). GMs are free to impose whatever restrictions they wish on this Power.

PRO **Portal (+2):** You can create portals through which others can travel.

TOTAL RECALL

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You automatically remember anything you pay attention to, and you can make an Intellect roll against whatever threshold the GM decides to see if you noticed specific background details as well.

PRO **Playback (+1):** Typically found among cyborgs and robots, your memories can be transferred, stored, copied, and displayed for others.

TRACER

Touch • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You can tag objects you touch with a tracer. Once tagged, you can follow objects anywhere in the world for the rest of the story. You might need to make an Intellect roll if the object moves to a location that somehow blocks this Power, but otherwise this is automatic. A person who suspects they've been tagged can search for your tracer, but finding it requires a Daunting (3) Perception roll.

PRO **Tracking (+3):** If you have an object that recently belonged to a subject or you visit a location the subject visited within the last day or so, you can track them as if they'd been tagged.

TRANSFORMATION

This Power lets you turn yourself into other things. The details vary depending on which version of this Power you have. Regardless of which Transformation Power you possess, changing form is always a free action, but you can only do so on your turn to act unless you forego you next turn to act.

ANIMAL FORMS

Self • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can turn into animals, gaining their appearance, form, size, and weight. You also gain their Agility, Might, Perception, and Toughness and their Powers at the lesser of their rank or your Power rank. You can turn into any natural animal you are familiar with, whether alive or extinct. As for magical creatures like dragons and unicorns, that's up to the GM. If you are an alien, you turn into alien animals. For the sake of game balance (and everyone's sanity), these alien animals look different but have the same characteristics as the Earth animals described in Chapter 8.

PRO **Enhanced (+4):** Whenever you turn into an animal, you can use your Power rank in place of its highest ranked Trait. You can do this for only one Trait per animal (pick one if several Traits have the same rank). For example, gorillas have 6d Might and Toughness. If you use 10d Animal Forms to turn into a gorilla, you can give yourself 10d in one of those Abilities.

CON **Only X (–2 or –4):** You can only turn into a specific category, group, or type of animal specified when you buy this Power. This is normally a –2 Con, but if you can only turn into a single animal or an extremely limited group of animals, this becomes a –4 Con instead.

DOPPELGANGER

Self • Default Rank • 6 Hero Points

You can turn into an exact duplicate of anyone you've ever seen, even aliens, as long as they're roughly humanoid in shape and not too much larger or smaller than you. You can fool biometric scanners and even DNA analysis, but you don't gain any of the subject's Abilities, Talents, or Powers.

OBJECT FORMS

Self • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can turn into objects, from simple geometric shapes to mundane tools and weapons to complex machines and vehicles. By turning into simple shapes, you can exert Power rank force or resistance. By turning into tools and weapons, you can add half your Power rank to the challenge rolls of anyone using you as a tool or the attack rolls of anyone using you as a weapon, up to a maximum rank equal to your Power rank. By turning into machines and vehicles, you gain their characteristics at the lesser of their rank or your Power rank. Although this doesn't affect your Traits, you can alter your size significantly when using this power, making yourself as large or as small as if you had the Growth and Shrinking Powers at this Power's rank.

SHAPESHIFTING

Self • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can reshape your gross physical form however you like. You have a number of Hero Points equal to your Power rank that can be used to temporarily raise your physical Abilities (Agility, Might, and Toughness) and to buy Powers that represent things like claws, extra limbs, fins, gills, spines, tentacles, tough hide, wings, and so on. No Trait can have a rank that exceeds the game's Trait Cap. For purposes of determining your Resolve (as discussed in Chapter 5), this Power's effective rank equals your Shapeshifting rank plus the greatest of your Agility, Might, or Toughness ranks.

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TRANSMUTATION

Touch • Power Rank • 2 Hero Points per rank

You can alter the chemical composition of inanimate matter that you touch. You can automatically affect gas within Close Range of you. To affect liquids or solids, you must make a Transmutation roll against the greater of their Structure or weight rank. By transforming elements and compounds, you can raise their Structure up to your Power rank or lower it as much as you wish, going as far as turning solids into liquids or gases, and vice versa. If you create energetic or harmful substances like chlorine gas, lava, or uranium, use your Power rank as their effect rank. These effects last for the rest of the scene or until you dispel them, but you can spend 1 Resolve to make them permanent if you wish. You also have to spend 1 Resolve to create elements and compounds that are unique to the game world or that have unique effects, such as magical metals or incredibly rare minerals that render a mighty superhero powerless because they're fragments of his home planet that exploded long ago.

TUNNELING

Self • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per rank

This Travel Power lets you travel by digging your way through the ground. You can collapse your tunnels behind you or leave them open for others to follow. You don't give any indication of your passage to those above ground, making this a great way to surprise your enemies.

TWO-DIMENSIONAL

Self • Default Rank • 6 Hero Points

You can become two-dimensional, like a shadow (whether you take on the appearance of a black silhouette is up to you). This renders you weightless and silent, but you can still affect and be affected by the three-dimensional world as usual. In addition to moving normally through three-dimensional space, you can also slide along any surface, ignoring gravity while doing so, and slip through any crack wide enough to fit your form while using this Power.

TWO-FISTED

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You use both hands in combat. You can spend 1 Resolve to defeat twice as many Minions as usual (2 per net success rolled) when making a physical attack. You can decide whether to spend the Resolve after making your attack roll. This Power applies to all physical attacks, but it provides no additional benefit to attacks that already work this way (i.e., area attacks, Super Speed attacks, and attacks involving the Ricochet Pro). If you happen to be dual wielding mundane weapons, you can also increase their Weapon Bonus by +1d. This bonus applies only to mundane weapons, not to Powers with Cons like Item or Weapons. To be clear, this Power does not grant extra attacks.

CON **Fighting/Marksmanship (–1):** This Power only applies in close combat and the bonus to mundane weapons applies only to melee weapons (Fighting), or it only applies in ranged combat and the bonus to mundane weapons applies only to ranged weapons (Marksmanship).

VANISH

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You can vanish from sight in the blink of an eye and move as far as you can in one page without anyone seeing where you went. This often happens under the cover of a blinding flash or a puff of smoke. Using this Power requires both 1 action (to vanish) and movement (to move elsewhere).



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VARIANT

Special • Special • 3 Hero Points

This Power grants you a different version of another power you already have. Although you only spend 3 Hero Points to buy a Variant Power, it must be worth the same number of Hero Points as the original. For example, if you have Blast (Ice) 8d, you could also have a Blast Variant (Fire) 10d (Charges 3): the 8d Blast costs 8 Hero Points, while the Blast Variant is also worth 8 Hero Points because the Charges Con saves you the 2 extra Hero Points you would normally have to spend to buy the power at 10d instead of 8d. You can't have a Variant of Alternate Form, Boost, Drain, Elemental Control, Nullify, Omni-Power, Power Absorption, Power Mimicry, or any other Power that affects other Traits.

VENTRILOQUISM

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You are a master of mimicry and ventriloquism. You can mimic almost any sound, imitate others effectively, and make your voice seem to come from another location. Use Charm when making challenge rolls for this ability, typically opposed by your target's Perception.

WALL-CRAWLING

Self • Power Rank • 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks

You can stick to walls and ceilings and can move along them at your normal speed. If your Power rank is lower than your Might, use your Power rank to determine how much weight you can carry while wall-crawling. You might need to make a Wall-Crawling roll to stick to unusually slick or slippery surfaces.

WEAKNESS DETECTION

Self • Default Rank • 3 Hero Points

You can find the weak points of any person or object you observe in person. If you spend 1 Resolve, your physical and energy attacks effectively gain the Penetrating Pro against that person or object for the rest of the scene. Additionally, this Power can also provide you with narrative information about the structural integrity, flaws, and stress points of any object you study (this doesn't cost Resolve).

SUPER TIP!

A player who selects Weakness Detection has given the GM a gift that lets them throw all sorts of unique and otherwise unconquerable Villains at the Heroes (consider the classic video game Shadow of the Colossus).

PROS AND CONS

The following section includes generic Pros and Cons. You can apply these options to existing Powers to create a wide variety of superpowers and unique abilities. Although the descriptions below generally refer to Powers, many Pros and Cons can also apply to Abilities, and some can even apply to Talents. The Pros and Cons provided below are not intended to cover every possible option, so feel free to make up your own.

AFFECT INANIMATE

PRO +1 Hero Point

This Pro applies to Powers that affect only living beings. It means the Power can also affect one type of inanimate being; in other words, characters with the Inanimate Power from one Source (pick one). You can apply this Pro multiple times to affect different types of inanimate beings.

AREA OF EFFECT

PRO +1 to +4 Hero Points

These Pros apply to Powers that only affect individual targets, turning them into Powers that target an area of effect. When targeting an area instead of an individual character in combat, you make a single attack roll and everyone in the area (whether friend or foe) makes their own defense roll. Area attacks are hard to evade, so active defense ranks are halved against them unless the defender foregoes their next turn to act leaping away or behind cover. The Pros are as follows.

Area/Burst: These Pros apply to Ranged Powers. Area gives you the option of targeting an area or an individual character, while Burst means the power always targets an area. Either way, the area of effect can be anywhere from 10 to 50 feet in diameter. Area lets you vary the size of the area of effect each time you use the Power, but Burst requires you to specify the size of the area when you create the Power. Area costs +2 Hero Points and Burst costs +1 Hero Point.

Zone/Nova: These Pros apply to Ranged Powers and Touch Powers. Zone gives you the option of targeting the area within 5 to 25 feet of you or an individual character. Nova means the power always targets the area within 5 to 25 feet of you. Zone lets you vary the size of the area of effect each time you use the Power, but Nova requires you to specify the size of the area when you create the Power. When applied to Ranged Powers, Zone costs +2 Hero Points and Nova costs +1 Hero Point. When applied to Touch Powers, these Pros cost twice as much, or +4 Hero Points and +2 Hero Points, respectively.

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ARMOR PIERCING

PRO +2 Hero Points

This Pro applies to Powers that inflict physical or energy damage. It means the Power penetrates body armor with ease. Characters wearing mundane armor have their passive defenses halved against the Power. Active defenses are unaffected by this Pro. No Power can have this Pro and the Weak Con.

BUILD-UP

CON –2 Hero Points

The Power must build up over 2 pages before you can use it. You can't use the Power on the first or second page of the action, but you can use it on the third page and every page after that.

BURNOUT

CON – 4 Hero Points

The Power is always at risk of burning out. Roll two dice every time you try to use it. A roll of 6 or less means the Power burns out and can't be used for the rest of the scene.

CARRIER ATTACK

PRO +6 Hero Points

This Pro applies to attack Powers. It means the attack Power carries another Power on its heels, called a **carrier attack**. The best real-world example of this is a poisoned weapon. Whenever the Power inflicts at least 1 point of damage or 1 page worth of a special effect, you can immediately make a second attack roll against the same target using the carrier attack. Targets can only use passive defenses against a carrier attack. Carrier attacks are expensive: you must buy this Pro and you must by the Power that will serve as the carrier attack. Carrier attacks can't be used independently. If you want to use a carrier attack by itself, you must buy a second version of the carrier attack Power.

CHARGES

CON –1 to – 4 Hero Points

The Power can only be used a few times per scene. This is a –1 Con if you can use the Power 6 times per scene, a – 2 Con if you can use it 3 times per scene, or a – 4 Con if you can use it once per scene. The Power is assumed to get recharged, reloaded, or otherwise readied between scenes. Powers with sustained effects like Invisibility or Phasing expend 1 use per page.

CLOSE

PRO +2 Hero Points or CON –2 Hero Points

This option applies to Touch Powers and Ranged Powers. It means the Power can target subjects within Close Range, even if they are not adjacent to you. This unique option is a +2 Pro when applied to Touch Powers, but a – 2 Con when applied to Ranged Powers.

PROS AND CONS

Affect Inanimate	Ongoing
Area of Effect	Only Inanimate
Armor Piercing	Overkill
Build-Up	Overload
Burnout	Penetrating
Carrier Attack	Phase Shift
Charges	Ranged
Close	Readied
Concentration	Recharge
Conditional	Resisted
Constant	Ricochet
Contagious	Selective
Costly	Shutdown
Degrades	Side Effect
Delay	Signature
Exclusive	Subtle/Undetectable
Expansive	Sustained
Fuse	Touch
Harmful	Toxin
Imbue	Trap
Independent	Two-Handed
Item	Uncontrolled
Limited	Unreliable
Line of Sight	Weak

CONCENTRATION

CON – 4 Hero Points

The Power requires your complete attention. Once you use the Power, you can't perform other actions, move, or defend yourself until your next turn to act. If the Power's effects last or can be maintained for more than one page, you must keep concentrating or the Power will instantly expire.

CONDITIONAL

CON –1 to – 4 Hero Points

The Power only works under certain conditions, in certain situations, against certain targets, after meeting certain requirements, etc. Considering how difficult it is to satisfy the conditions, this is a –1 Con if the Power often works, a – 2 Con if it occasionally works, or a – 4 Con if it rarely works.

CONSTANT

CON –2 Hero Points

This Con applies to Powers that can be activated and deactivated at will. It means the Power is always active and cannot be switched off. This Con is only meaningful when this poses a problem. For example, Aura, Blast, Density, Growth, Invisibility, and Shrinking are all good candidates for this Con.

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CONTAGIOUS

PRO +4 Hero Points

The Power affects not only your original target, but also anyone who comes into physical contact with them. As long as the original target is affected by the Power, you can make an immediate attack roll against anyone who touches them, and these new potential targets can only use passive defenses to resist the Power. New targets affected by the Power also become contagious. This effect always expires at the end of the current scene, at least for Heroes. NPCs have no such restrictions.

COSTLY

CON –4 Hero Points

You must spend 1 Resolve every time you use the Power. This can represent a Power that takes a great deal out of you, one you have yet to master, or one you are reluctant to use.

DEGRADES

CON –2 Hero Points

This Con applies to Power Rank Powers and Baseline Rank Powers. It means the Power gets weaker the more you use it. Every use of the Power reduces its effective rank by 1d for the rest of the scene. When this Con applies to ongoing Powers like Aura, every page or fraction of a page is considered one use. All lost ranks are recovered between scenes.

DELAY

CON –4 Hero Points

The Power doesn't take effect immediately. Although the length of the delay is up to you (specify when you create the Power), it must be too long for the Power to be of use in combat.

EXCLUSIVE

CON –1 Hero Point

You can't use or maintain the Power while you are using or maintaining another Power with this Con, typically because these Powers come from or rely on the same device, energy, source, etc. You must apply this Con to at least 2 of your Powers (and you get the cost reduction for each).

EXPANSIVE

PRO +6 to +18 Hero Points

This Pro applies to Zone Powers, letting you increase their area of effect dramatically. You can spend 1 Resolve to expand the Power's area of effect for the rest of the scene. This costs 6 Hero Points if you can affect everything within Close Range (about 50 feet), 12 Hero Points if you can affect everything within Distant Range (about 500 feet), or 18 Hero Points if you can affect everything within Extreme Range (about 5,000 feet). Although not available to Heroes, NPCs can have a Geographic version of this Pro that can affect as large an area as the GM deems

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appropriate. You cannot apply this Pro to Powers that affect targets directly like Dazzle or Shockwave, but indirect Powers like Darkness, Illusions, Irritant, Light, Nullify, Slick, and Time Stop are perfectly valid.

FUSE

PRO +2 Hero Points

You can set the Power to take effect after a delay. This delay can be as short or as long as you wish, but not longer than a number of hours equal to your Willpower. You decide how long you want the delay to last each time you use the Power. As long as you are within Extreme Range of where you set the Power to go off or take effect, you can deactivate it at will.

HARMFUL

CON –1 to –4 Hero Points

You suffer damage every time you use the Power. This is a –1 Con if the Power inflicts 1 point of damage per use, a –2 Con if it inflicts 1–3 points of damage per use (roll one die and halve the result), or a –4 Con if it inflicts 1–6 points of damage per use. You are always free to spend 1 Resolve to avoid suffering this damage. This damage is considered subdual damage, but it ignores the Regeneration Power and can't be healed with ordinary medical treatment.

IMBUE

PRO +4 Hero Points

This Pro applies to Powers that only affect you. It means you can also use the Power on other characters and/or objects (whatever makes sense for the Power). You must touch whatever you want to imbue with the Power. Your Willpower equals the maximum number of subjects you can affect at the same time. You can't affect anything with a weight rank greater than your Willpower.

INDEPENDENT

PRO +6 Hero Points

The Power has a mind of its own, like a homing missile or a mechanical tentacle that can act of its own accord. The Power can operate like a separate character whenever you wish, acting when you do and using its rank to make any necessary challenge rolls. Although this leaves you free to take other actions without penalty, you can't use the Power on any page in which it acts independently.

ITEM

CON –1 Hero Point

The Power comes from an item you carry or wear. Objects implanted into your body are not considered items for these purposes. When you apply this Con to a Power, you must decide whether the item is mundane or unbreakable. Mundane items can be damaged or destroyed, but they can also be repaired or replaced without too much trouble. Unbreakable items are almost impossible to damage or destroy, but they must be recovered if lost, stolen, or taken from you. You must also decide if others can use the item; there are advantages and disadvantages either way. When this Con is applied to an Ability or Talent, its rank drops to 2d if the item is taken away or stops working, but you are free to spend Hero Points to raise the Trait's default rank above this 2d baseline.

LIMITED

CON –1 to –4 Hero Points

The Power is less effective, potent, or useful than usual. This is a –1 Con if the Power is somewhat limited, a –2 Con if it's significantly limited, or a –4 Con if it's severely limited. Use this Con as a catch-all when nothing else seems appropriate.

LINE OF SIGHT

PRO +2 to +6 Hero Points

The Power can affect targets at Extreme Range. This is a +2 Pro when applied to Powers that can be used at Distant Range, a +4 Pro when applied to Powers that can be used at Close Range, or a +6 Pro when applied to Powers that require physical contact (Touch Powers). This Pro can't be applied to Martial Arts, but it can be applied to Strike (Throw) as a +4 Pro. When this Pro is applied to a Zone Power, the Power's area of effect no longer needs to be centered on the character using it.

ONGOING

PRO +6 Hero Points

This Pro applies to Powers that inflict damage. It means the Power keeps inflicting damage after the initial attack, doing 1 extra point of damage at the beginning of the following page and continuing for a number of pages equal to the damage inflicted by the original attack. For example, if you hit a target with an ongoing attack and inflict 3 points of damage, the target will take 1 extra point of damage at the start of each of the next 3 pages. This effect isn't cumulative over multiple attacks: you always inflict only 1 point of damage per page, and you always use only the longest effective duration. Targets can spend 1 Resolve or forego their next turn to act to rid themselves of all ongoing attacks affecting them.

ONLY INANIMATE

CON –1 to –4 Hero Points

This Pro applies to Powers that only affect living beings. It means the Power affects inanimate beings instead. This is a –1 Con if you can affect characters with the Inanimate Power from any Source, a –2 Con if you can affect characters with the Inanimate Power from 2 Sources (pick them), or a –4 Con if you can affect characters with the Inanimate Power from one Source (pick one).

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OVERKILL

CON (Special)

The Power is more damaging or potent than it is accurate. As a result, targets double the total number of successes rolled when using an active defense to resist the Power in combat. This unusual Con reduces a Power's base cost by 1 Hero Point per rank (or changes its base cost from 1 Hero Point per rank to 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks). As noted earlier, this Con can also be applied to Might. Aside from being ordinary Cons, Overkill and its opposite Weak (see below) are tools GMs can use to regulate their games and balance characters of disparate power levels. Consider the following examples:

GMs who want to expand how powerful Heroes can be without raising the game's Trait Cap may let Heroes have higher Trait ranks if they use the Overkill or Weak Cons. When using this optional rule, a Trait with either Con can exceed the Trait Cap by up to 3 ranks in games with a Trait Cap of at least 9d or by up to 6 ranks in games with a Trait Cap of at least 18d.

Conversely, GMs who want to limit how powerful Heroes can be without lowering the game's Trait Cap may rule that all Traits of a certain rank or higher must have either Overkill or Weak if they inflict damage. The rank that triggers this requirement is up to the GM, but it should never be lower than 9d.

OVERLOAD

PRO +2 Hero Points

You can overload the Power, increasing its effective rank but burning it out in the process. You can increase the Power's rank by 3d or 6d for one page. If you increase it by 3d, you lose the Power for the rest of the scene. If you increase it by 6d, you lose the Power for the rest of the issue. If this Pro is applied to a Variant Power or to the original Power on which a Variant is based, it burns out the original Power and all Variants (whether or not they have this Pro) when used.

PENETRATING

PRO +4 Hero Points

This Pro applies to Powers that inflict physical or energy damage, and means they cut through physical objects like a hot knife through butter. Passive defenses are halved against the Power. Force fields are the exception; a target protected by the Force Field Power is immune to this effect. Active defenses are unaffected by this Pro. No Power can have this Pro and the Weak Con.

PHASE SHIFT

PRO +4 Hero Points

The Power affects insubstantial and incorporeal targets as if they were solid. For example, characters using Powers like Gaseous Form, Liquid Form, and Phasing are considered solid when targeted by the Power. This also works in reverse, meaning that characters who are incorporeal (those using Phasing) can use the Power against ordinary solid targets. GMs are free to prohibit Heroes who can become incorporeal from using this Pro since it allows them to affect the physical world while remaining immune to physical attacks and effects. Of course, NPCs are not subject to this restriction.

RANGED

PRO +2 or +4 Hero Points

The Power can affect targets at Distant Range. This is a +2 Pro when applied to Powers that can be used at Close Range or a +4 Pro when applied to Powers that require physical contact (Touch Powers). This Pro can't be applied to Martial Arts, but it can be applied to Strike (Throw) as a +2 Pro. When this Pro is applied to a Zone Power, the Power's area of effect no longer needs to be centered on the character using it.

READIED

CON –2 Hero Points

The Power must be readied between each use. You must spend 1 page to ready the Power, but if you spend 1 Resolve, you can do it in 1 action instead. Whether or not you spend Resolve, you can move and perform free actions while readying the Power.

RECHARGE

CON –4 Hero Points

The Power must recharge between uses. It can only be used once every 3 pages. In other words, once you use the Power, you can't use it again for the next 2 pages.

RESISTED

PRO +6 Hero Points

This Pro applies to Powers that inflict special effects and can be resisted with active defenses. It means the Power never misses or doesn't need to make contact. As a result, targets cannot use active defenses to resist the Power. This Pro is always subject to the GM's approval.

RICOCHET

PRO +2 Hero Points

This Pro applies to ranged attack Powers. It means you can bank the Power off multiple surfaces, letting you target enemies around corners or behind cover without suffering a penalty to your attack rolls. Additionally you can spend 1 Resolve to defeat

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twice as many as Minions usual, or 2 per net success rolled, by bouncing the Power off multiple enemies — this provides no additional benefit to attacks that already work this way (i.e., area attacks, Super Speed attacks, and Two-Fisted attacks). You can decide whether to spend Resolve after making your attack roll.

SELECTIVE

PRO +4 Hero Points

The Power will not harm or affect anyone you don't want harmed or affected. If the Power can be used to perform area attacks or has an Area of Effect Pro, you can spend 1 Resolve whenever you make an area attack to target only select individuals in the area of effect.

SHUTDOWN

CON –1 to –4 Hero Points

Either the Power can't affect a person or object it should be able to affect, or something can prevent the Power from working and/or shut it down. Considering how often the Power is impaired, this is a –1 Con if the Power often works, a –2 Con if it occasionally works, or a –4 Con if it rarely works.

SIDE EFFECT

CON –1 to –4 Hero Points

The Power has a detrimental side effect such as causing collateral damage, creating a terrible smell, killing nearby plant life, etc. The side effect must be more than the obvious effect of the Power. For example, all area attacks cause collateral damage, so that can't be a side effect for a typical area attack Power. This is a –1 Con if the side effect is annoying or inconvenient, a –2 Con if the side effect is detrimental or harmful, or a –4 Con if the side effect is catastrophic or debilitating.

SIGNATURE

CON –1 Hero Point

The Power leaves a residue, energy signature, or something else that can be detected by anyone who knows what to look for and traced back to you. Describe the specifics when you apply this Con.

SUBTLE/UNDETECTABLE

PRO +2 or +6 Hero Points

Subtle is a +2 Pro that means the Power creates no loud noise, bright light, nor anything else that can easily be detected from a distance. Undetectable is a +6 Pro that means the Power can't be detected or traced back to you, at least not by ordinary senses. It also means you give no indication when using the Power. For example, you can use Telekinesis (Undetectable) to grab a purse snatcher and hold them in the air until the police arrive while appearing to be nothing more than an ordinary person sitting at an outdoor café minding their own business. Targets suffer a –3d penalty to their active defense rolls against Undetectable physical and energy attacks unless they have a Power like Blind Fighting that compensates for this. GMs are well within their rights to prohibit Heroes from using Undetectable.

SUSTAINED

CON –2 Hero Points

This Con applies to Powers that last or can be maintained for some amount of time. It means you must spend 1 action per page sustaining the Power. If not, the Power instantly expires.

TOUCH

CON –2 or –4 Hero Points

The Power requires physical contact. This is a –2 Con when applied to Powers that can be used at Close Range or a –4 Con when applied to Powers that can be used at Distant Range.

TOXIN

CON –2 Hero Points

The Power represents a disease, drug, or poison. It can't affect characters who are immune to toxins, and targets can use the Resistance Power as a passive defense against the Power.

TRAP

PRO +2 Hero Points

You can trap an area or object with the Power. Once set, the trap is triggered by anyone who enters the area or handles the object incorrectly (or at all). Powers that affect others use their rank to make any necessary attack rolls when triggered. Each trap can run up to 15 feet long, cover an area up to 5 feet in diameter (or a single 5-foot by 5-foot square), or affect an object small enough to fit into this space. You can always trap a small part of a large object. Your Willpower equals the maximum number of traps you can have set at any time. Traps that have not been triggered vanish at the end of the current issue.

TWO-HANDED

CON –1 Hero Points

You need both hands free to use the Power. This often means you must gesture with both hands or the Power comes from an object or weapon you wield in both hands.

UNCONTROLLED

CON –2 Hero Points

This Con applies to Powers that can be activated and deactivated at will. It means the Power always activates in certain situations. You have no control over this and can't stop it from happening. This Con is only meaningful when the specific circumstances are problematic.

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UNRELIABLE

CON –2 Hero Points

The Power sometimes fails to work. Roll two dice every time you try to use it. A roll of 6 or less means the Power doesn't work and you waste your action. You can try again on the following page.

WEAK

CON (Special)

The Power is more accurate than it is damaging or potent. As a result, targets double the total number of successes rolled when using a passive defense to resist the Power in combat. This unusual Con reduces a Power's base cost by 1 Hero Point per rank (or changes its base cost from 1 Hero Point per rank to 1 Hero Point per 2 ranks). No Power can have this Con and the Armor Piercing or Penetrating Pros.



PERKS

Perks are advantages that come from the world around you. Like many of the Powers, Perks are generic and need to be fleshed out when selected. As social characteristics, Perks are more narrative than mechanical in nature. Perks don't have ranks or Sources and don't take Pros or Cons. Feel free to make up your own Perks using the ones provided below as a guide.

AUTHORITY

Perk • 3 Hero Points

You have more authority, rights, or social power than the average person. This could include things like access to secret government installations, diplomatic immunity, top secret security clearance, authority to arrest and detain people, or just being a member of the nobility or ruling class.

CONTACTS

Perk • 1 Hero Point per type of contact

You know people who can provide you with information and the occasional favor. Common examples include academic, business, criminal, legal, media, military, police, political, and scientific contacts.

FAME

Perk • 3 Hero Points

You are famous. People who recognize you generally react favorably, and some will fall all over themselves trying to get your attention, an autograph, or a selfie with you. If you have a secret identity, you must decide whether this Perk applies to your civilian identity or your heroic alter ego.

FOURTH WALL

Perk • 6 Hero Points

You believe you are a character in a comic book (and you might be right). You often break the fourth wall to interact directly with the audience. In game terms, any time you break the fourth wall and crack a joke that gets everyone at the table laughing, you earn 1 point of Resolve. But you can only do this once per scene. This Perk is best reserved for comedic or lighthearted games.

HEADQUARTERS

Perk • 1 Hero Point per 3 Base Points

You have a base of operations or headquarters of some kind. Every Hero Point you spend on this Perk gives you 3 Base Points to spend on your headquarters. Multiple Heroes can apply their Base Points to the same headquarters. You can find rules for creating headquarters in Chapter 6.

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INFAMY

Perk • 3 Hero Points

You are infamous among the criminal underworld, known as a dangerous customer and someone to be feared. Ordinary criminals are afraid of you and may fall all over themselves trying to appease you, especially when you apply the right kind of pressure. Supervillains are usually less impressed.

PATRON

Perk • 3 Hero Points

You are connected to a person, group, or organization that provides you with information, equipment, funding, and support for your heroic activities. Common patrons include government organizations, rebel groups, and wealthy humanitarians who just love adopting teenagers with superpowers.

PET/SIDEKICK

Perk • 1 Hero Point per 10 Hero Points

You have a pet or a sidekick. Every Hero Point you spend on this Perk gives you 10 Hero Points to create this character. Your companion can't have more than half your Hero Points, and they must abide by the game's Trait Cap. Your companion earns 1 Hero Point for every 2 that you earn. Pets and sidekicks are considered Heroes. They lack Resolve, but you can spend your Resolve on their behalf. If your companion has higher Trait ranks than you, use their Traits when determining your Resolve (see Chapter 5). If your companion has Flaws, you earn Resolve as if that character were a Hero. GMs who don't want players running two (or more) characters should feel free to limit or prohibit this Perk.

REPUTATION

Perk • 3 Hero Points

You have a reputation that works to your benefit. Unlike fame, which makes people like you, this Perk means you have authority, credibility, or respect in a particular arena. For example, in your civilian life, you might be an attorney known to be an absolute terror in the courtroom. If you have a secret identity, you must decide whether this Perk applies to your civilian identity or your heroic alter ego.

RESOURCES

Perk • 1 Hero Point

You have access to an impressive supply of equipment of one sort or another: military weapons, ninja gear, tricked-out vehicles, etc. This often means you know someone who gets you these things or you stumbled across a hidden cache. It does not mean you are rich. For that, see Wealth.

PERKS

Authority	Patron
Contacts	Pet/Sidekick
Fame	Reputation
Fourth Wall	Resources
Headquarters	Unique Vehicle
Infamy	Wealth/Great Wealth

UNIQUE VEHICLE

Perk • 1 Hero Point per 25 Vehicle Points

You have one or more unique vehicles. Every Hero Point you spend on this Perk gives you 25 Vehicle Points to spend on your vehicles. Rules for creating unique vehicles are in Chapter 6.

WEALTH/GREAT WEALTH

Perk • 3 or 6 Hero Points

Wealth costs 3 Hero Points and means you are rich. You aren't just comfortably well-off; you are truly wealthy. You can buy almost anything you want, legal or otherwise. You probably own several homes, have multiple vehicles, and employ at least a few domestic servants. If you happen to be a tech-based Hero, you can easily fund your extracurricular activities out of your own pocket.

Great Wealth costs 6 Hero Points and means you are one of the wealthiest people in the world. At this level, money is almost meaningless. Not only can you buy whatever you want, but you can spend 1 point of Resolve once per issue to make a truly absurd purchase like buying an island or a major corporation. While many Heroes are wealthy, GMs may want to restrict Great Wealth because characters with this much money can spend their way around most problems without batting an eye.

FLAWS

Flaws are physical, mental, and social hindrances. As noted earlier, all Heroes can have up to 3 Flaws and must have at least one. The following section includes several Flaws common to the superhero genre, but feel free to make up your own (after discussing them with your GM).

Flaws not only make your Hero more interesting; they also help you earn Resolve. Whenever you find yourself in a situation where one of your Flaws could become an issue, you can bring it into play by describing what happens. If this makes things more difficult for you or your fellow Heroes, you earn 1 point of Resolve. Your Flaws are always under your control and come into play only when you decide. No Flaw can generate more than 1 Resolve per scene.

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Although most Flaws work as described above, there are two exceptions. Some Flaws like Enemy and Relationship are plot hooks for GMs to use however they wish. Others like Blind and Vulnerability are persistent conditions that can't be resisted and are always in effect. These Flaws are sometimes called **Plot Hooks** and **Conditions**, respectively, and they aren't under your control. You don't bring Plot Hooks or Conditions into play to earn Resolve. Instead, these Flaws grant you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue, and that's it. They come into play whenever the GM decides or the situation demands, and you don't gain extra Resolve when that happens.

NPC FLAWS

Flaws work differently for NPCs. NPCs often have less than 3 Flaws, and sometimes have none. That's because, unlike Heroes, NPCs always succumb to their Flaws. For example, a Villain with the Fear (heights) Flaw will always avoid open balconies, ledges, etc. The only way for an NPC to overcome a Flaw is with Adversity. Once per scene, the GM can spend 1 Adversity to have an NPC resist a Flaw for the rest of that scene (and no NPC can resist the same Flaw more than once per issue). This also applies to friendly NPCs, but in this case, it costs Resolve instead of Adversity (a Hero must spend the Resolve).

For these reasons, NPCs usually have Flaws that are always in effect or triggered by a particular person, object, situation, etc., and the specifics must be described in detail when the NPC is created. Flaws that don't have a concrete effect on a character's interactions with Heroes are usually ignored or added purely for descriptive purposes. The same goes for Flaws that don't come up very often, mainly affect the character's personal life, or take effect off-screen. Unless otherwise noted in a character's write-up, Flaws like these are merely descriptive when applied to NPCs. While they may occasionally come up in play, their effects are entirely up to the GM.

The following Flaws are assumed to be merely descriptive when applied to NPCs: Absentminded, Alter Ego, Amnesia, Broke, Clumsy, Color Blind, Creepy, Decorum, Emotionless, Enemy, Finite Power, Frightening, Hidden Agenda, Illiterate, Impaired Sense, Insane, Light Sensitive, Nocturnal, Notoriety, Obligation, Outsider, Quirk, Relationship, Restriction, Secret, Secret Identity, Slow, Unlucky/Jinx, and Wanted. This isn't to say these Flaws aren't real or have no effect on NPCs. It only means that their impact is completely up to the GM. If the GM wants any of these Flaws to have a specific mechanical effect, they have to describe it in detail on a case-by-case basis.

ABSENTMINDED

You tend to forget things. Usually, the things you forget aren't all that important. But sometimes they are. Whenever that happens, you earn a point of Resolve.

ALTER EGO

You have a mundane alter ego. Your alter ego is built with 50 Hero Points and earns 1 Hero Point for every 5 you earn. Decide how your transformation works and whether it has any limitations when you select this Flaw. Any time this causes you trouble, you earn a point of Resolve.

AMNESIA

You have no memory of your past, although you may be haunted by fragments in dreams or visions. You don't know who you are or where you come from. People who know this can take advantage of you, and your past will come back to haunt you every so often. This Flaw is both a Plot Hook and a Condition, so it grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue.

AVERSION/FEAR

You have an aversion to or fear of something, and you will do whatever you can to avoid it. If you can't, you may become hysterical, nauseated, violent, or worse. You may even pass out. However it works, you earn a point of Resolve whenever you succumb to this Flaw. Common fears include a fear of the dark, enclosed spaces, fire, heights, insects, mice, public speaking, snakes, spiders, and water.

BEAST

Your mental faculties are about on par with a bright animal or a game designer. You act mostly on instinct, and complex reasoning is beyond you. You earn a point of Resolve any time you can't figure out how to do things like open a door or get the sheriff to understand that Billy fell down a well.

BLIND/DEAF

You are completely blind or deaf (pick one). If you are blind, you may have to select at least one Power that compensates enough to let you operate as a superhero (discuss this with your GM). This Flaw is a Condition that grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue.

BROKE

You are penniless, jobless, and possibly homeless. You can't buy anything, so you have to beg, borrow, or steal what you need. Every time this causes you problems, you earn a point of Resolve.

CLUMSY

For whatever reason, you tend to break things. Your allies know to keep the fragile stuff away from you. Nevertheless, accidents happen. When they do, you earn a point of Resolve.

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CODE

You follow a rigid code of conduct, one that requires more of you than just acting heroically. You earn a point of Resolve whenever following your code hurts you or your allies.

COLOR BLIND

You see in black and white, or you have trouble distinguishing certain colors (reds and greens being the usual culprits). You earn a point of Resolve whenever this causes you problems.

COMPULSION/SEVERE COMPULSION

You have trouble resisting the urge to do something like drinking, gambling, chasing potential romantic partners, grandstanding, proving that your intellect is unmatched, or working on that stupid roleplaying game all night long. You earn a point of Resolve any time this works to your detriment. If the compulsion is literally impossible to resist, then you have a Severe Compulsion, which is a Condition that grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue. If you have a Severe Compulsion, you must describe the specific environment, situation, etc. that triggers the compulsion.

CREEPY

You give off a vibe that unnerves sensitive observers like young children, psychics, and animals. Animals usually shy away from you, unless they're predators, in which case they attack you first. You earn a point of Resolve whenever your unsettling aura causes you trouble.

CURSE

You suffer from some supernatural burden. Make up the details and get your GM's approval. You earn a point of Resolve whenever your curse causes problems for you or your allies.

DECORUM

You value propriety and feel compelled to follow social mores, even when others don't. Manners maketh man, and all that. Whenever this makes life difficult, you earn a point of Resolve.

DISABLED

You are disabled, possibly missing a limb or two, possibly wheelchair-bound, possibly something else. Describe the specifics when you select this Flaw. You may have to select at least one Power that compensates enough to let you operate as a superhero (discuss this with your GM). This Flaw is a Condition that grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue.

FLAWS

- Absentminded
- Alter Ego
- Amnesia
- Aversion/Fear
- Beast
- Blind/Deaf
- Broke
- Clumsy
- Code
- Color Blind
- Compulsion (Severe)
- Creepy
- Curse
- Decorum
- Disabled
- Emotionless
- Enemy
- Finite Power
- Flashbacks/Guilt
- Frenzy
- Frightening
- Heavy/Very Heavy
- Hidden Agenda
- Illiterate
- Impaired Sense
- Insane
- Light Sensitive
- Mute
- Night Blind
- Nocturnal
- Notoriety
- Obligation
- Outsider
- Power Limits
- Quirk
- Reaction (Severe)
- Relationship
- Repair
- Requirement (Severe)
- Restriction
- Secret
- Secret Identity
- Slow
- Unlucky/Jinx
- Unusual Looks
- Unusual Shape
- Vulnerability
- Wanted

EMOTIONLESS

You lack human empathy. Unable to understand emotions, you are often coldly logical in your interactions with others. As a result, people tend to react poorly to even your most carefully reasoned attempts at meaningful exchange. You earn a point of Resolve any time this causes you problems.

ENEMY

You have an enemy that wants you ruined, imprisoned, or dead. Make up whatever details you want and let your GM make up the rest. Your enemy doesn't necessarily have to be a single individual or a super-powered nemesis. It could instead be a group, an organization, or even an entire nation. This Flaw is a Plot Hook that grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue.

FINITE POWER

One or more of your Powers requires ammo, energy, or some other depletable resource. You earn a point of Resolve whenever you run out of this resource at the wrong time.

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FLASHBACKS/GUILT

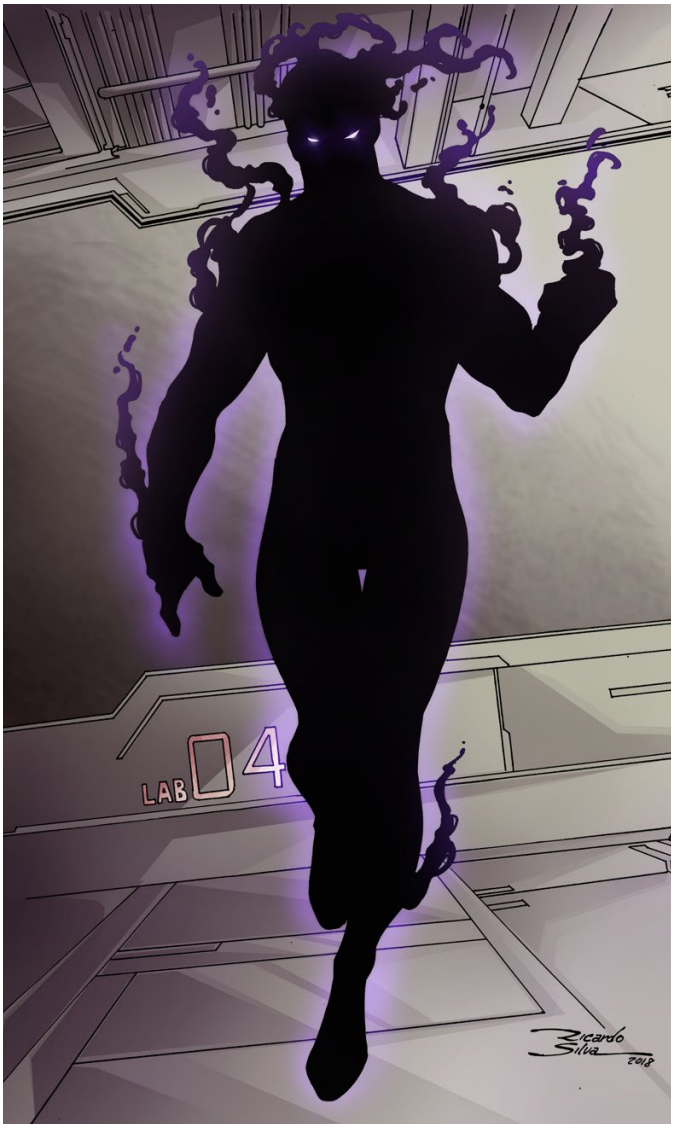
You are haunted by some tragic event in your past. Whenever something triggers you, you suffer flashbacks or become overwhelmed with guilt, sorrow, etc. Flashbacks take you completely out of the action and render you helpless for 1 page. Being overwhelmed with guilt causes you to suffer a –2d penalty to all challenge rolls for 3 pages. Either way, you also earn a point of Resolve.

FRENZY

You tend to rush headlong into combat and often go dangerously berserk. You earn a point of Resolve whenever this gets the better of you and makes you do something stupid like leap blindly into a fight, refuse to retreat with your allies, or kill someone in the heat of battle.

FRIGHTENING

You look downright scary. Most people flee in terror when they see you, and those who don't are often on edge in your presence. You earn a point of Resolve whenever this causes you problems.



HEAVY/VERY HEAVY

You weigh a good bit more than the average person. If you have a weight rank of 5d or 6d, you are Heavy. You can't ride most mounts, and you are probably a poor swimmer at best. You earn a point of Resolve whenever your weight becomes an issue. If you have a weight rank of 7d or greater, you are Very Heavy, heavy enough to damage floors and crash through ceilings. At this level, you have a Condition that grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue.

HIDDEN AGENDA

You sometimes have directives or goals you can't/won't discuss with your allies. Whenever your hidden agenda gets in the way or makes things difficult for you or your allies, you earn a point of Resolve.

ILLITERATE

You cannot read or write, at least not any language known on present-day Earth. You earn a point of Resolve whenever this hampers you in a significant way.

IMPAIRED SENSE

Your hearing, smell, or vision is lousy — pick one or more, whatever you prefer. You earn a point of Resolve whenever you choose to automatically fail a Perception roll as a result of your impairment and your failure has some adverse consequence for you or your allies.

INSANE

You suffer from a persistent behavioral issue, delusion, or disconnect with reality or you endure occasional psychotic breaks in the form of hallucinations, bouts of paranoia, etc. Whenever your illness causes you problems, you earn a point of Resolve. If you take medication that keeps you in check, consider taking Requirement instead.

LIGHT SENSITIVE

You are sensitive to bright light. You might be an albino, but that doesn't have to be the case. Simple daylight can be blinding, and prolonged exposure can make you dizzy or incapacitate you. You earn a point of Resolve any time you suffer an adverse effect because of this condition.

MUTE

You can't speak, won't speak, or speak a language nobody else understands (although maybe another Hero can translate for you). Any time this creates challenges for your or your allies, you earn 1 Resolve. This Flaw doesn't prevent you from speaking to your fellow players or the GM; it only prevents your Hero from speaking to other characters in the game world.

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NIGHT BLIND

You have a hard time seeing in dim lighting, which is almost like darkness to you. You earn a point of Resolve any time you suffer an adverse effect because of this condition.

NOCTURNAL

You are wired to sleep during the day, or you have a form of narcolepsy. Either way, you tend to be tired and sluggish during the day, and you sometimes doze off when things are calm — shaving cream beards are all too familiar. Whenever this becomes an issue, you earn a point of Resolve.

NOTORIETY

Whether deserved or not, you have a bad reputation. Maybe you've become the target of a newspaper editor who hates "costumed freaks." Perhaps you used to be a supervillain and the public hasn't forgiven or forgotten. Or you might be the unfortunate subject of blind prejudice. Whatever the case, most people react unfavorably to you. Some may even flee or call the police when you appear. When things like this happen, you sigh and earn a point of Resolve.

OBLIGATION

You have a duty or responsibility that requires you to do certain things and prevents you from doing others. Being a student and having a full-time job are common Obligations on present-day Earth. This Flaw is a Plot Hook that grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue.

OUTSIDER

You come from somewhere else, often another time, world, or dimension. Your home is quite different from present-day Earth, so there are bound to be faux pas and missteps. You earn a point of Resolve any time you have trouble dealing with novel objects or situations.

POWER LIMITS

One or more of your Powers has certain limitations. Describe the specifics. In effect, this works like a Con that you control, but instead of making the Power less expensive, this Flaw lets you earn 1 point of Resolve whenever this works to your detriment or to that of your allies.

QUIRK

You have an annoying, obnoxious, or unfortunate personality trait that often gets the better of you at the worst of times. You earn a point of Resolve whenever that happens.

REACTION/SEVERE REACTION

You suffer an adverse reaction at certain times, in certain situations, or when you touch or come within a certain distance of a specific person, place, or thing. Make up the details when you select this Flaw. However it works, you earn a point of Resolve whenever you suffer a reaction, or when you do something selfish or unheroic to avoid whatever causes your reaction. If your reaction is especially severe and impossible to resist, like how sunlight burns vampires, then you have a Severe Reaction, which is a Condition that grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue.

RELATIONSHIP

You have important relationships in your life, often your friends and family (and maybe even pets). These people and/or animals require your attention and occasionally need your help, sometimes to rescue them from the clutches of some Villain, and sometimes for other reasons. This common Flaw is a Plot Hook that grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue.

REPAIR

You do not heal naturally. Whenever you suffer damage, you must be repaired to recover lost Health, whether that happens magically, mechanically, or in some other way. This Flaw is a Condition that grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue.

REQUIREMENT/SEVERE REQUIREMENT

You must satisfy a requirement every so often or you will suffer an adverse effect. Maybe you have to perform a nightly ritual to maintain your powers, or you need regular doses of medicine to stay alive, or perhaps you are addicted to alcohol, drugs, or gambling. Make up the details when you select this Flaw. You earn a point of Resolve whenever you do something selfish or unheroic to satisfy the requirement, or when you suffer an adverse effect from not satisfying the requirement. If the requirement is desperate and immediate, like breathing water instead of air, then you have a Severe Requirement, which is a Condition that grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue.

RESTRICTION

You have fewer rights than the average person, often because you are a minor or an undocumented alien (maybe literally). This also applies if you are a second-class citizen, were deemed legally incompetent, etc. Whenever your restriction makes things difficult, you earn a point of Resolve.

SECRET

You have a secret that must be kept at all costs. You earn a point of Resolve whenever your efforts to protect your secret work to your detriment or to the detriment of your allies.

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SECRET IDENTITY
This is the iconic version of the Secret Flaw in most comic book superhero settings.

SLOW
You move slowly. You earn a point of Resolve whenever you choose to automatically fail an Agility roll involving speed or movement and the failure has negative consequences for you or your allies. This Flaw is almost meaningless if you have a Travel Power that compensates for it.

UNLUCKY/JINX
If it weren't for bad luck, you wouldn't have any luck at all. Unlucky means the GM can inflict a misfortune on you once per issue without needing to spend Adversity (for more on this, see Chapter 5). Jinx works the same way, but the misfortune affects a fellow Hero or ally in your vicinity instead of you. This Flaw is a Condition that grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue.

UNUSUAL LOOKS
Your appearance is off-putting. You might look incredibly ugly, unnaturally beautiful, or strange and uncanny in some other way. Whatever the case, you earn a point of Resolve whenever your appearance becomes an issue. This Flaw is redundant if you have Frightening.

UNUSUAL SHAPE
You are not shaped like an ordinary human being. Describe how you are shaped and how this affects you when you select this Flaw. Whenever this causes you problems, you earn a point of Resolve.

VULNERABILITY
You are vulnerable to one type of attack, effect, or weapon. Describe it in detail when you select this Flaw. Your active and passive defense ranks are halved against this attack, effect, or weapon. This Flaw is a Condition that grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue.

WANTED
On a steel horse you ride. You are being actively hunted by authorities of some kind, so your hand is often forced in order to avoid being discovered, or to escape in those instances when you are. This Flaw is a Plot Hook that grants you 1 extra point of Resolve at the start of every issue.

DERIVED CHARACTERISTICS
To avoid having to look these things up during the game, you should now determine your Edge, Health, and Resolve. Edge and Health are described in Chapter 4. Resolve is discussed at length in Chapter 5.

EDGE
Your Edge equals your Perception plus the greater of your Agility or Intellect. Note that certain Powers like Danger Sense, Lightning Reflexes, and Super Speed can affect your Edge.

HEALTH
Your Health equals the average of your Toughness and Might or the average of your Toughness and Willpower. Use whichever option gives you the most Health. When creating a Foe, use half this value. As discussed later in these rules, this is more a suggestion than a rule when dealing with NPCs.

RESOLVE
Your Resolve depends on how close your Ability ranks and Power ranks come to the game's Trait Cap. Turn to Chapter 5 to determine your Resolve. Note that the Determination Power and certain Flaws (Plot Hooks and Conditions) grant you extra starting Resolve. Only Heroes have Resolve.

FINISHING TOUCHES
Now that you have your Abilities, Talents, Powers, Perks, and Flaws, you get to add your **finishing touches**. These are the descriptive elements that turn a collection of game mechanics into a living, breathing character in the game world. Your finishing touches include your name and civilian identity, a description, your motivation, a quote, three connections, three details, and your origin.

NAME AND IDENTITY
Select your superhero name and your actual name, or at least the one you use in your civilian identity. Most Heroes, even those with public identities, tend to use a heroic codename.

DESCRIPTION
Describe the three things people first notice about you when they meet you in costume, then describe the three things they first notice when they meet you in everyday civilian attire. Although your costume is obviously important, you can also include things like your personality and demeanor, the way you move or carry yourself, the way you speak (or don't speak), and so on.

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MOTIVATION

Not everyone with superpowers would choose to be a superhero. Most people would decide to lead normal lives, free of the troubles and dangers that come with the whole hero gig. But not you; you are different, and your motivation explains why. Although Heroes can have more than one motivation, there's always one that underlies everything else. Motivations are generic, so two vastly different Heroes can nevertheless share the same motivation. As Heroes mature, their motivations may change.

ADVENTURE

You are a superhero for the adventure and excitement of it. You may be young, going through a phase or a mid-life crisis, or one of those people who need to live life on the edge. Of course, there are plenty of ways to get an adrenaline rush, and the fact that you choose to do it in a way that protects others says a great deal about your good-hearted, heroic nature.

ALTRUISM

You are a superhero because it's the only reasonable course of action for you and others like you, at least if you want the world to have any kind of future. You've given this a lot of thought, and while you may or may not be especially good or noble, you can't escape your conclusion. Some Heroes with this motivation have genius-level intelligence, but others are ordinary folks who sat down at the kitchen table trying to figure out what they were going to do after discovering they had superhuman abilities.

CAREER

You work as a superhero for the government, military, police, or some other organization. Or maybe you are a hero-for-hire or a private detective with powers, although it can be tough to make ends meet since you can't seem to turn away anyone who needs your help, even if they can't pay. You might even be chasing the fame and wealth that comes with being a super-powered celebrity. Whatever the case, you try to balance a no-nonsense levelheadedness with your drive to serve and protect others.

DEVOTION

You are a superhero because of someone else. Someone you love is a superhero and you want to impress, protect, act as a mentor, or keep them out of trouble. Or someone you care about needs you to be a superhero, for whatever reason, so here you are. Although this motivation is less altruistic than most, many Heroes who start out with this motivation come to develop an appreciation for doing the right thing and eventually drop this motivation in favor of another.

IDEALISM

You are a superhero because you espouse or embody the noblest ideals of a people, group, or nation. You live by your ideals, and through your selfless heroics, you inspire others to do the same. This doesn't make you a mindless follower, nationalist, or zealot. You believe in the dream, first and foremost, so much so that if the people, group, or nation who once espoused your ideals suddenly turns its back on them, you will be the first to plant yourself firm and say, "No, you move."

MOTIVATIONS

Adventure	Knowledge
Altruism	Nature
Career	Redemption
Devotion	Responsibility
Idealism	Trouble
Justice	Virtue

JUSTICE

The system is supposed to protect people, but that doesn't always happen. Some crimes are too big or too small. Some criminals are too powerful or too slippery. And some victims are too invisible or too unpopular. When the system fails, it's up to people like you to fill the gaps, protect the innocent, and right the wrongs. You fight to protect those you can, and to get justice for those you can't.

KNOWLEDGE

You are on a quest for knowledge or spiritual enlightenment, and your heroics arise out of helping those you encounter along the way. Maybe you seek to explore unknown frontiers, invent new technologies, or push science and human understanding to new horizons. Maybe you are looking inward, learning to tap your infinite potential, or trying to understand yourself and your place in the universe. You might even be an alien or a robot trying to understand what it means to be human.

NATURE

You are a superhero because that's what your instincts tell you to be — it's in your DNA or hardwired into your programming. You might be a noble beast whose natural instincts lead you to acts of heroism. You could be insane, disconnected from reality, but your actions always have you on the side of the angels. Or you could be a construct of some kind, like a robot or clockwork soldier, programmed for heroism.

REDEMPTION

You have made mistakes, and now you are trying to redeem yourself. Your need for redemption might be internal, the desire to make amends for your past, or it might be external, a promise offered in exchange for forgiveness or leniency. At least it might have started that way, with you coerced into this life, until you woke up one morning and realized this is who you were meant to be all along.

RESPONSIBILITY

You have abilities and powers that most don't, and you have a duty to use them for the good of others. Maybe this is how you were raised, or maybe this was recently made clear to you. You could have a heroic obligation of some kind, a legacy to live up to. Or maybe you just have a deep respect for the value of law and order in a civil society. You act out of a sense of duty and take being a superhero seriously.

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TROUBLE

You have a problem, one you can't solve on your own, so you sought the assistance of other superheroes or their patron. Maybe you developed powers you need to learn to control. Perhaps you were dying, and your powers are the byproduct of some magical or technological process that saved your life. Maybe you need super-powered help to save someone you love, or to protect yourself from someone or something. Maybe you were coerced into being a superhero, or at least you were at first. Or perhaps you just want to find a place where you'll be accepted rather than seen as a freak or a monster.

VIRTUE

You are a superhero because it's the right thing to do. People are supposed to do what they can to help each other. Your special abilities let you do more than most, so you do. It's that simple. An optimist, you will never stop fighting for the dignity and freedom of every human being. If you didn't have superpowers, you would find another way to work for the good of others.

QUOTE

Whether a catchphrase you repeat constantly or a one-time zinger, your quote sums you up in a single phrase or sentence that ties everything else together. If they ever make a movie about you, the quote is the line everyone's going to remember long after leaving the theater. Feel free to leave this one blank and come back to it after you've played a few games and gotten to know your Hero a little better.

CONNECTIONS

Describe at least three people who play an important role in your life. This doesn't necessarily mean you like these folks, or even know them. It just means they're connected to you in some way. Connections can include family members, friends, pets, coworkers, rivals, and so on. If you have Perks like Contacts or Patrons, these people don't count as connections unless they're important to you on a personal level, in which case you can make them connections if you wish. You don't have to actually create these Extras, leave that to your GM. Simply describe who they are and how they're connected to you so the GM can bring these people into the game when they want to make a story personal to you.

DETAILS

The second-to-last step is to make up at least three details: one about you, one about one of the other Heroes in the group that somehow relates to you, and one about someone or something out there in the game world that somehow relates to you. You can make up any details you want. They can be related to each other or not. They can involve the past, the present, or the future. They can involve your backstory, your history, or your fate. And whether you or anyone else knows or believes these things to be true is entirely up to you. The only requirement is that each detail must provide the GM with a plot hook that can be used as the basis of a subplot or story. The GM must approve your details, and your fellow player must approve the detail about their Hero. Otherwise, the sky's the limit.

ORIGIN

The last thing to do is describe how you became a superhero. You don't have to write a novel. In fact, a simple sentence or two that leaves a lot to the imagination can sometimes be more evocative than pages of backstory. And be prepared to read it, because the first thing that should happen once everyone creates their Heroes is that each player should read their origin to the rest of the group. The Heroes may not know one another's backstories at the start of the game, but the players usually should.

ADVANCEMENT

Character advancement is not a major theme of the superhero genre. Most well-known comic book characters are iconic, changing little over time. This reliable sameness is part of their charm, and why they keep getting rebooted every few years. On those rare occasions when superheroes do change, it often comes as a sudden and dramatic transformation rather than slow and steady growth. Despite this, P&P includes rules for character advancement because that's part of the fun of playing a roleplaying game. Players expect their Heroes to become more capable over time, and there's a lot to be said for watching your creation go from rookie crime fighter to veteran superhero. As with everything else, feel free to alter or ignore these rules to suit your game.

GAINING HERO POINTS

GMs should award each player 1 Hero Point roughly every 3 issues. These points should be awarded after the Heroes complete a story. If your group tends to complete stories in a single issue, you may want to award Hero Points every few stories instead. Each Hero should also receive 1 Hero Point any time they accomplish something truly noteworthy. For example, Heroes who defeat an archvillain or save an entire city (state, country, planet, etc.) from imminent destruction should be awarded an extra Hero Point.

In addition to the above, Heroes are awarded 1 Hero Point whenever they experience a major life event like a marriage, the birth of a child, the death of a loved one, or any other important event in their personal life. At least some part of this event must occur in the game rather than off screen. Although these life events are driven by the players, GMs are always free to add whatever potential drama and excitement they wish. Only one Hero can experience a major life event per story, so players are expected to take turns doing this over the course of a series. Occasionally, these events can involve the entire group, like when two Heroes get married and the rest are invited to the wedding. The GM is free to bar major life events from happening in certain issues or stories, as well as to limit how often they can happen at all, thereby dialing the game's soap opera level up or down as desired.

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SPENDING HERO POINTS

New Hero Points can be spent to buy new characteristics or improve existing ones. Everything costs the same as during character creation. For example, raising your Might by 1d costs 1 Hero Point, while raising your Super Speed by 1d costs 3 Hero Points. If you raise a Trait that acts as a Power's baseline rank, that Power increases in rank as well. For example, if you have 3d Might and 9d Strike, raising Might to 4d will raise Strike to 10d because Might is the baseline rank for Strike.

Heroes can also spend Hero Points to buy extra Flaws. The first 3 Flaws are always free, so characters with less than 3 can make up the difference without spending Hero Points. The fourth, fifth, and sixth Flaws cost 3 Hero Points each. No Hero can have more than 6 Flaws (unless the GM approves). If you ever grow tired of a Flaw or feel like your Hero has outgrown or overcome it, you can swap it out for a different Flaw between stories. This doesn't cost Hero Points, but you need to explain how this happened. Players shouldn't do this too often, though, or Flaws will start to feel meaningless.

TRAIT CAPS

Games can have a **hard Trait Cap** or a **floating Trait Cap**, as determined by the GM. Hard Trait Caps never change, no matter how many Hero Points the characters earn. Floating Trait Caps, on the other hand, increase over time. Ordinarily, a floating Trait Cap increases by +1d for every 10 Hero Points a Hero earns through advancement. In other words, the game's Trait Cap increases by +1d once a Hero earns 10 Hero Points, by another +1d once they earn 20 Hero Points, and so on.

As an alternative, GMs are free to ignore the above and instead simply increase the game's floating Trait Cap whenever they think it's appropriate. In game terms, this might be after the Heroes defeat an archvillain or accomplish a major milestone in the series. In comic book terms, this might be after each *Special Issue* or *Anniversary Issue*. However they handle this, GMs always have the absolute right to control the Trait Cap in their games and raise it at whatever speed they wish, if at all.

RETCONS

Every so often, players should also be allowed to **retcon** their Heroes. In the comics, a retcon (short for retroactive continuity) is a dramatic change made to a character or another important element of a series, often one that rewrites established canon to some degree. In P&P, a retcon refers to letting players change their Heroes however they wish. This can run from something as small as swapping a few Ability and Talent ranks to something as large as completely redesigning a Hero from the ground up. As long as the character costs the same number of Hero Points, anything goes during a retcon, subject to the GM's final approval. As in the comics, retcons can be explained within the story of the game or they can be hand-waved — do whatever works best for your game.

RANDOM HERO GENERATOR

If you find yourself at a loss when trying to create a new Hero, see if anything on the following tables sparks your imagination. If that doesn't do it, roll randomly to see what kind of character develops. Of course, this is just for ideas and inspiration — you aren't bound by these rolls.

NATURE

Your **nature** describes what kind of being you are. You can select your nature from the following options, or you can roll 2 dice and check the **Random Natures** table to let fate decide. If you want to make things interesting, roll 3 dice instead of two, making sure the third die is a different color. If you roll a 6 on the third die, it means you have two natures. Pick a second nature or roll a second time (and you may as well add that third die to this roll as well, because why not)

RANDOM NATURES

ROLL	NATURE
2	Animal
3	Construct
4	Alien
5 – 9	Human
10	Unearthly
11	Mythic
12	Plant

Alien: You are from another planet. You may be a new arrival to Earth, or you might have travelled here as a baby so that this is the only home you know. If you look human, you might not even know about your alien heritage. The differences between you and ordinary humans may be invisible to the naked eye, little more than cosmetic, or enough to grant you tremendous abilities under our yellow sun.

Animal: You are an animal that has somehow become sentient, or maybe you were always that way. You might be an alien, mythic, or unearthly being who happens to be intelligent, or you may have become sentient as a result of whatever event or process granted you your other special abilities.

Construct: You are an artificial being like an android, a magical construct, a robot, or a vat-grown human simulacrum. While many constructs are inanimate, many others are as alive as any living creature. Your special abilities are often inherent, part of how you were designed or intended to function.

Human: You are an ordinary human being. While you probably come from present-day Earth, you may be from another time, another dimension, or both. Regardless, you are just an ordinary person, or at least you were at some point before you gained or developed your superhuman abilities.

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Mythic: You are a magical creature or a member of a hidden culture or race like an amazon, centaur, dragon, dwarf, elf, faerie, ghost, ghoul, immortal, merman/mermaid, minotaur, mummy, nymph, ogre, revenant, satyr, troll, vampire, werewolf, or zombie.

Plant: You are a sentient, plant-based life form. You may always have been this way, or perhaps the same alteration or enhancement that granted you your special abilities made you sentient as well. At least some of your special abilities are probably the result of your unique physiology.

Unearthly: You are a being from another dimension or plane of existence, like an angel, demon, or demigod, or maybe you come from some otherworldly realm where such beings reside. Some or all your special abilities are attributable to your inhuman or extradimensional nature.

BASIC ORIGIN

Your **basic origin** provides a general idea of how you developed your special abilities. Although this may suggest what your special abilities represent (i.e., their Source) you always have the final say and can give your Powers whatever Source you want. You can select your basic origin from the following options, or you can roll 1 die and check the **Random Origins** table to let fate decide. If you want to make things interesting, roll 2 dice instead of one, making sure the second die is a different color. If you roll a 6 on the second die, it means you have two basic origins. Pick a second one or roll a second time (and while you're at it go ahead and roll that extra die again as well).

RANDOM ORIGINS

ROLL	BASIC ORIGIN
1	Altered
2	Designed
3	Equipped
4	Gifted
5	Inherited
6	Skilled

Altered: You were altered or transformed in some way. This might have been the result of a random accident, event, or occurrence, or you may have been intentionally enhanced with biotech, cybernetic implants, experimental gene therapy, magical tattoos, permanent spells, etc. If you are a construct, you were modified or redesigned for something other than your original purpose.

Designed: You were created or designed to have your special abilities. This basic origin is most applicable to Constructs, so feel free to select this without rolling if you are a Construct or to reroll this result if you are anything else (although you can make this work for any nature).

Equipped: Your special abilities come from one or more objects you acquired or made. These objects might be tools you actually use, like a high-tech suit of powered armor or a magic sword, or they might instead be talismans or sources of power, like a ring charged with cosmic energy.

Gifted: You were born with your special abilities, although they may not have developed until later in life. Your abilities are not shared by other members of your race or species; they are unique to you. You are special: blessed or cursed, a genetic anomaly, a mutant, the one, etc.

Inherited: You were born with your special abilities or they developed naturally. Your special abilities are shared by other members of your race or species, so you probably aren't human. But you might be, in which case destiny, fate, prophecy, or a unique bloodline may be the source of your powers.

Skilled: Most of your special abilities are the result of intense training, whether physical, mental, or mystical. The rest often represent arms, armor, and equipment you have at your disposal.

SUPER TIP!

Your origin isn't about how you got your powers. It's about why you're a superhero. A Hero's origin is usually what cements their Motivation in place.

SOURCES

These are the Sources for your Powers and Abilities with a rank of 7d or greater. Abilities of rank 6d or less are assumed to be Innate, and Talents are assumed to be Trained, regardless of their rank, but these defaults aren't mandatory. If you select or roll other Sources and would like to apply them to your Abilities and Talents, you are free to do so. Decide how many Sources you want to use, then pick the ones you want or roll one die and check the **Random Sources** table for each.

RANDOM SOURCES

ROLL	SOURCE
1	Innate
2	Magic
3	Psychic
4	Super
5	Tech
6	Trained

ARCHETYPES

In this context, your **archetype** refers to a type of character, set of powers, or both. Select one or more of the following archetypes. If you prefer to do this randomly, roll 2 dice and use the lower roll to determine the number of archetypes you will use to create your character. Then roll 2 more dice and check the **Random Archetypes** table. In this case you are looking at the number rolled on each die separately, so use differently colored dice and determine which to read first before rolling (or decide after rolling, giving you 2 options per roll).

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RANDOM ARCHETYPES

ROLL	ARCHETYPE
11	**Acrobat:** You are agile and can often leap great distances, climb walls, and use a swing line.
12	**Archer or Gunslinger:** You are a sharpshooter who may use trick arrows or ammo.
13	**Battlesuit:** You wear a suit of armor that grants you your special abilities.
14	**Beast:** You have animal or insect abilities, often natural attacks, and enhanced senses.
15	**Blaster or Marksman:** You are a ranged combatant who uses energy or physical attacks.
16	**Brawler:** You are a scrapper who specializes in armed or unarmed combat.
21	**Controller:** You can inflict some unique special effect or effects on your opponents.
22	**Cyber-Soldier:** You are an experienced soldier, often cybernetically enhanced.
23	**Detective:** You are an expert sleuth and a two-fisted crime fighter.
24	**Dominator:** You control or deceive others and make them see or do what you wish.
25	**Duplicator:** You create hordes of duplicates or summon hordes of minions
26	**Energy Controller:** You can project and control a type of energy.
31	**Force Manipulator:** You can generate force constructs or force fields, maybe both.
32	**Gadgeteer:** You rely on a variety of gadgets and gizmos.
33	**Ghost:** You can become insubstantial to one degree or another.
34	**Life Drinker:** You consume life energy, maybe even blood.
35	**Lucky:** You are extremely lucky, sometimes unbelievably so.
36	**Magician:** You have a power that lets you do almost anything you can imagine.
41	**Malleable:** You can deform and reshape your body to one degree or another.
42	**Matter Manipulator:** You have absolute control over a type of matter.
43	**Mimic/Siphon:** You mimic or absorb Traits from other characters.
44	**Ninja/Spy/Thief:** You are sneaky and can get into and out of places without being detected.
45	**Nullifier:** You can dampen or drain other characters' Traits.
46	**Powerhouse/Tank:** You are super strong, tremendously resistant to harm, or both.
51	**Psychic:** You are psionically sensitive and can detect what others cannot.
52	**Searo:** You are aquatic, likely physically powerful, and may have other aquatic abilities.
53	**Sensor:** Your senses are incredibly acute, or you have senses normal humans lack.
54	**Shapeshifter:** You can turn into other forms or other things.
55	**Size Changer:** You can change your size, growing, shrinking, or both.
56	**Speedster:** You can move at superhuman speeds.
61	**Technomancer:** You can control technology.
62	**Telekinetic:** You can move physical objects with your mind.
63	**Telepath:** You can send thoughts, read minds, and engage in psychic combat.
64	**Teleporter:** You can instantly transport yourself from one place to another.
65	**Weather Controller:** You can control the weather and create powerful weather effects.
66	**Winged Hero:** You are a winged superhero and probably an agile combatant.

MOTIVATION

Last, if you're having trouble deciding what makes your Hero tick, start with your motivation. After all, that's what drives you to be a superhero in the first place. Your motivation may also suggest something about your background, especially when combined with your basic origin above. As usual, you can select one of the motivations from the **Random Motivations** table or roll 2 dice and leave it up to fate. When rolling on this table, use differently colored dice. If the first die is odd, use the number rolled on the second die. If the first die is even, use the number rolled on the second die plus 6.

RANDOM MOTIVATIONS

ROLL	MOTIVATION
1	Adventure
2	Altruism
3	Career
4	Devotion
5	Idealism
6	Justice
7	Knowledge
8	Nature
9	Redemption
10	Responsibility
11	Trouble
12	Virtue

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